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Contents

Intellectual Property Rights 6

Foreword 6

1 Scope 7
1.1 References 7
1.2 Abbreviations 8

2 General 8

3 Handover 9
3.1 Overall process 9
3.2 MS measurement procedure 9
3.3 BSS measurement procedure 9
3.4 Strategy 9

4 RF power control 10
4.1 Overall process 10
4.2 MS implementation 10
4.3 MS power control range 10
4.4 BSS implementation 10
4.5 BSS power control range 10
4.6 Strategy 11
4.7 Timing 11
4.8 Dedicated channels used for a voice group call or voice broadcast 11

5 Radio link failure 11
5.1 Criterion 11
5.2 MS procedure 12
5.3 BSS procedure 12

6 Idle mode tasks 12
6.1 Introduction 12
6.2 Measurements for normal cell selection 13
6.3 Measurements for stored list cell selection 13
6.4 Criteria for cell selection and reselection 14
6.5 Downlink signalling failure 15
6.6 Measurements for Cell Reselection 15
6.6.1 Monitoring of received signal level and BCCH data 16
6.6.2 Path loss criteria and timings for cell re-selection 16
6.7 Release of TCH and SDCCH 17
6.7.1 Normal case 17
6.7.2 Call re-establishment 18
6.8 Abnormal cases and emergency calls 18

7 Network pre-requisites 19
7.1 BCCH carriers 19
7.2 Identification of surrounding BSS for handover measurements 19

8 Radio link measurements 20
8.1 Signal level 20
8.1.1 General 20
8.1.2 Physical parameter 20
8.1.3 Statistical parameters 21
8.1.4 Range of parameter 22
8.2 Signal quality 22
8.2.1 General 22
8.2.2 Physical parameter 22
8.2.3 Statistical parameters 22
8.2.4 Range of parameter 22

8.3 Aspects of discontinuous transmission (DTX) 23
8.4 Measurement reporting 24
8.4.1 Measurement reporting for the MS on a TCH 24
8.4.2 Measurement reporting for the MS on a SDCCH 25
8.4.3 Additional cell reporting requirements for multi band MS 25
8.4.4 Common aspects for the MS on a TCH or a SDCCH 26
8.4.5 Measurement reporting for the BSS 26
8.4.6 Extended measurement reporting 27
8.5 Absolute MS-BTS distance 27
8.5.1 General 27
8.5.2 Physical parameter 27

9 Control parameters 28

10 GPRS mode tasks 30
10.1 Cell Re-selection 30
10.1.1 Monitoring the received signal level and PBCCH data 31
10.1.1.1 Packet idle mode 31
10.1.1.2 Packet transfer mode 31
10.1.2 Cell Re-selection Criteria 32
10.1.3 Cell Re-selection Algorithm 33
10.1.3.1 Abnormal cell reselection 34
10.1.4 Network controlled Cell re-selection 34
10.1.4.1 Measurement reporting 35
10.1.4.2 Cell re-selection command 36
10.1.4.3 Exceptional cases 36
10.1.5 Extended Measurement reporting 36
10.2 RF Power Control 37
10.2.1 MS output power 37
10.2.2 BTS output power 38
10.2.3 Measurements at MS side 38
10.2.3.1 Deriving the C value 38
10.2.3.1.1 Packet idle mode 38
10.2.3.1.2 Packet transfer mode 39
10.2.3.2 Derivation of Channel Quality Report 40
10.2.3.2.1 Packet transfer mode 41
10.2.3.2.2 Packet idle mode 41
10.2.4 Measurements at BSS side 42
10.3 Measurement requirements 42
10.4 Control parameters 42

Annex A (informative): Definition of a basic GSM or DCS 1 800 handover and RF power control algorithm 45

A.1 Scope 45

A.2 Functional requirement 45

A.3 BSS pre-processing and threshold comparisons 46
A.3.1 Measurement averaging process 46
A.3.2 Threshold comparison process 47
A.3.2.1 RF power control process 47
A.3.2.2 Handover Process 48

A.4 BSS decision algorithm 49
A.4.1 Internal intracell handover according to radio criteria: (Interference problems) 50
A.4.2 Internal handover according to other criteria 50
A.4.3 General considerations 50

A.5 Channel allocation 50
A.6 Handover decision algorithm in the MSC 51

Annex B (informative): Power Control Procedures 53

B.1 Open loop control 53
B.2 Closed loop control 54
B.3 Quality based control 54
B.4 BTS power control 55
B.5 Example 55

Annex C (informative): Change Request History 57

History 59

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Foreword

This European Standard (Telecommunications series) has been produced by the Special Mobile Group (SMG).

The present document specifies the Radio sub-system link control implemented in the Mobile Station (MS), Base Station System (BSS) and Mobile Switching Centre (MSC) of the digital mobile cellular and personal communication systems operating in the 900 MHz and 1 800 MHz band (GSM 900 and DCS 1 800).

The contents of the present document are subject to continuing work within SMG and may change following formal SMG approval. Should SMG modify the contents of the present document it will then be republished by ETSI with an identifying change of release date and an increase in version number as follows:

Version 6.x.y

where:

6 indicates release 1997 of GSM Phase 2+

x the second digit is incremented for all changes of substance, i.e. technical enhancements, corrections, updates, etc.

y the third digit is incremented when editorial only changes have been incorporated in the specification.

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1 Scope

The present document specifies the Radio sub-system link control implemented in the Mobile Station (MS), Base Station System (BSS) and Mobile Switching Centre (MSC) of the GSM and DCS 1 800 systems.

Unless otherwise specified, references to GSM also include DCS 1 800.

1.1 References

The following documents contain provisions which, through reference in this text, constitute provisions of the present document.

- References are either specific (identified by date of publication, edition number, version number, etc.) or non-specific.
- For a specific reference, subsequent revisions do not apply.
- For a non-specific reference, the latest version applies.
- A non-specific reference to an ETS shall also be taken to refer to later versions published as an EN with the same number.

[1] GSM 01.04: "Digital cellular telecommunications system (Phase 2+); Abbreviations and acronyms".

[2] GSM 03.03: "Digital cellular telecommunications system (Phase 2+); Numbering, addressing and identification".

[3] GSM 03.09: "Digital cellular telecommunications system (Phase 2+); Handover procedures".

[4] GSM 03.22: "Digital cellular telecommunications system (Phase 2+); Functions related to Mobile Station (MS) in idle mode and group receive mode".

[5] GSM 04.04: "Digital cellular telecommunications system (Phase 2+); Layer 1; General requirements".

[6] GSM 04.06: "Digital cellular telecommunications system (Phase 2+); Mobile Station - Base Station System (MS - BSS) interface; Data Link (DL) layer specification".

[7] GSM 04.08: "Digital cellular telecommunications system (Phase 2+); Mobile radio interface layer 3 specification".

[8] GSM 05.02: "Digital cellular telecommunications system (Phase 2+); Multiplexing and multiple access on the radio path".

[9] GSM 05.05: "Digital cellular telecommunications system (Phase 2+); Radio transmission and reception".

[10] GSM 05.10: "Digital cellular telecommunications system (Phase 2+); Radio subsystem synchronization".

[11] GSM 06.11: "Digital cellular telecommunications system; Full rate speech; Substitution and muting of lost frames for full rate speech channels".

[12] GSM 08.08: "Digital cellular telecommunications system (Phase 2+); Mobile-services Switching Centre - Base Station System (MSC - BSS) interface, Layer 3 specification".

[13] GSM 08.58: "Digital cellular telecommunications system (Phase 2+); Base Station Controller - Base Transceiver Station (BSC - BTS) interface; Layer 3 specification".

[14] GSM 11.10: "Digital cellular telecommunications system (Phase 2+); Mobile Station (MS) conformity specification".

[15] GSM 03.64: "Digital cellular telecommunications system (Phase 2+); General Packet Radio Service (GPRS); Overall description of the GPRS Radio Interface; Stage 2".

1.2 Abbreviations

Abbreviations used in the present document are listed in GSM 01.04.

2 General

The radio sub-system link control aspects that are addressed are as follows:

- Handover;
- RF Power control;
- Radio link Failure;
- Cell selection and re-selection in Idle mode, in Group Receive mode and in GPRS mode (see GSM 03.22).

Handover is required to maintain a call in progress as a MS engaged in a point-to-point call or with access to the uplink of a channel used for a voice group call passes from one cell coverage area to another and may also be employed to meet network management requirements, e.g. relief of congestion.

Handover may occur during a call from one TCH or multiple TCHs (in the case of multislot configuration) to another TCH or multiple TCHs. It may also occur from DCCH to DCCH or from DCCH to one or multiple TCH(s), e.g. during the initial signalling period at call set-up.

The handover may be either from channel(s) on one cell to other channel(s) on a surrounding cell, or between channels on the same cell which are carried on the same frequency band. Examples are given of handover strategies, however, these will be determined in detail by the network operator.

For a multiband MS, specified in GSM 02.06, the handover described is also allowed between any channels on different cells which are carried on different frequency bands, e.g. between a GSM 900/TCH and a DCS 1 800/TCH. Handover between two co-located cells, carried on different frequency bands, is considered as inter-cell handover irrespective of the handover procedures used.

Adaptive control of the RF transmit power from an MS and optionally from the BSS is implemented in order to optimize the uplink and downlink performance and minimize the effects of co-channel interference in the system.

The criteria for determining radio link failure are specified in order to ensure that calls which fail either from loss of radio coverage or unacceptable interference are satisfactorily handled by the network. Radio link failure may result in either re-establishment or release of the call in progress. For channels used for a voice group call, an radio uplink failure results in the freeing up of the uplink.

Procedures for cell selection and re-selection whilst in Idle mode (i.e. not actively processing a call), are specified in order to ensure that a mobile is camped on a cell with which it can reliably communicate on both the radio uplink and downlink. The operations of an MS in Idle Mode are specified in GSM 03.22.

Cell re-selection is also performed by the MS when attached to GPRS, except when the MS simultaneously has a circuit switched connection. Optional procedures are also specified for network controlled cell re-selection for GPRS. Cell re-selection for GPRS is defined in subclause 10.1.

An MS listening to a voice group call or a voice broadcast use cell re-selection procedures to change cell. This may be supported by a list of cells carrying the voice group or voice broadcast call downlink, provided to the MS by the network. The operations of an MS in Group Receive Mode are specified in GSM 03.22.

Information signalled between the MS and BSS is summarized in tables 1, 2 and 3. A full specification of the Layer 1 header is given in GSM 04.04, and of the Layer 3 fields in GSM 04.08.

3 Handover

3.1 Overall process

The overall handover process is implemented in the MS, BSS and MSC. Measurement of radio subsystem downlink performance and signal levels received from surrounding cells, is made in the MS. These measurements are signalled to the BSS for assessment. The BSS measures the uplink performance for the MS being served and also assesses the signal level of interference on its idle traffic channels. Initial assessment of the measurements in conjunction with defined thresholds and handover strategy may be performed in the BSS. Assessment requiring measurement results from other BTS or other information resident in the MSC, may be performed in the MSC.

GSM 03.09 describes the handover procedures to be used in PLMNs.

3.2 MS measurement procedure

A procedure shall be implemented in the MS by which it monitors the downlink RX signal level and quality from its serving cell and the downlink RX signal level and BSIC of surrounding BTS. The method of identification of surrounding BTS is described in subclause 7.2. The requirements for the MS measurements are given in subclause 8.1.

3.3 BSS measurement procedure

A procedure shall be implemented in the BSS by which it monitors the uplink RX signal level and quality from each MS being served by the cell. In the case of a multislot configuration the evaluation shall be performed on a timeslot per timeslot basis. A procedure shall be implemented by which the BSS monitors the levels of interference on its idle traffic channels.

3.4 Strategy

The handover strategy employed by the network for radio link control determines the handover decision that will be made based on the measurement results reported by the MS/BSS and various parameters set for each cell. Network directed handover may also occur for reasons other than radio link control, e.g. to control traffic distribution between cells. The exact handover strategies will be determined by the network operator, a detailed example of a basic overall algorithm appears in annex A. Possible types of handover are as follows:

Inter-cell handover:

Intercell handover from the serving cell to a surrounding cell will normally occur either when the handover measurements show low RXLEV and/or RXQUAL on the current serving cell and a better RXLEV available from a surrounding cell, or when a surrounding cell allows communication with a lower TX power level. This typically indicates that an MS is on the border of the cell area.

Intercell handover may also occur from the DCCH on the serving cell to a TCH or multislot configuration on another cell during call establishment. This may be used as a means of providing successful call establishment when no TCH resource is available on the current serving cell.

Inter-cell handover between cells using different frequency bands is allowed for a multi band MS.

Intra-cell handover:

Intra-cell handover from one channel/timeslot in the serving cell to another channel/timeslot in the same cell will normally be performed if the handover measurements show a low RXQUAL, but a high RXLEV on the serving cell. This indicates a degradation of quality caused by interference even though the MS is situated within the serving cell. The intra-cell handover should provide a channel with a lower level of interference. Intra-cell handover can occur either to a timeslot on a new carrier or to a different timeslot on the same carrier. Similarly, intra-cell handover may occur between different multislot configurations in the same cell. These multislot configurations may comprise different number of timeslots and may partly overlap.

Intra-cell handover from one of the bands of operation to another one is allowed for a multiband MS.

GSM 08.08 defines the causes for handover that may be signalled from BSS to MSC.

4 RF power control

4.1 Overall process

RF power control is employed to minimize the transmit power required by MS or BSS whilst maintaining the quality of the radio links. By minimizing the transmit power levels, interference to co-channel users is reduced.

4.2 MS implementation

RF power control shall be implemented in the MS.

The power control level to be employed by the MS on each uplink channel, except PDCH , is indicated by means of the power control information sent either in the layer 1 header of each SACCH message block (see GSM 04.04) on the corresponding downlink channel, or in a dedicated signalling block (see GSM 04.08). Power control for PDCH is defined in subclause 10.2 .

The MS shall employ the most recently commanded power control level appropriate to each channel for all transmitted bursts on either a TCH (including handover access burst), FACCH, SACCH or SDCCH.

The MS shall confirm the power control level that it is currently employing in the SACCH L1 header on each uplink channel. The indicated value shall be the power control level actually used by the mobile for the last burst of the previous SACCH period.

In case of a multislot configuration, each bi-directional channel shall be power controlled individually by the corresponding SACCH. Power control information on downlink unidirectional channels shall be neglected.

When accessing a cell on the RACH (random access) and before receiving the first power command during a communication on a DCCH or TCH (after an IMMEDIATE ASSIGNMENT), all GSM and class 1 and class 2 DCS 1 800 MS shall use the power level defined by the MS_TXPWR_MAX_CCH parameter broadcast on the BCCH of the cell. The class 3 DCS 1 800 MS shall use the power level defined by MS TXPWR MAX CCH plus the value POWER OFFSET also broadcast on the BCCH of the cell.

If a power control level defined in GSM 05.05 is received but the level is not supported by the MS, the MS shall use the supported output power which is closest to the output power indicated by the received power control level.

4.3 MS power control range

The range over which a MS shall be capable of varying its RF output power shall be from its maximum output down to its minimum, in steps of nominally 2 dB.

GSM 05.05 gives a detailed definition of the RF power level step size and tolerances.

4.4 BSS implementation

RF power control may optionally be implemented in the BSS.

4.5 BSS power control range

The range over which the BSS shall be capable of reducing its RF output power from its maximum level shall be nominally 30 dB, in 15 steps of nominally 2 dB.

GSM 05.05 gives a detailed definition of the RF power level step size and tolerances.

4.6 Strategy

The RF power control strategy employed by the network determines the ordered power level that is signalled to the MS, and the power level that is employed by the BSS.

The power level to be employed in each case will be based on the measurement results reported by the MS/BTS and various parameters set for each cell. The exact strategies will be determined by the network operator. A detailed example of a basic algorithm appears in annex A.

4.7 Timing

Upon receipt of a command from an SACCH to change its power level on the corresponding uplink channel, the MS shall change to the new level at a rate of one nominal 2 dB power control step every 60 ms (13 TDMA frames), i.e. a range change of 15 steps should take about 900 ms. The change shall commence at the first TDMA frame belonging to the next reporting period (as specified in subclause 8.4). The MS shall change the power one nominal 2 dB step at a time, at a rate of one step every 60 ms following the initial change, irrespective of whether actual transmission takes place or not.

In case of channel change, except for multislot configuration change, the commanded power control level shall be applied on each new channel immediately. The multislot configuration change message does not command the MS to use new power control levels. For those time slots not used by the MS before the multislot configuration change procedure, the MS shall use the power control level used on the main channel before the multislot configuration change.

4.8 Dedicated channels used for a voice group call or voice broadcast

The network shall not allocate the uplink of the channel used for a voice group call to more than one MS. If marked busy, no other MS shall transmit on the channel. This marking is indicated by the network, as defined in GSM 03.68 and 04.08. Any MS allocated the uplink of a channel used for a voice group call shall only transmit if the uplink is marked busy, and shall stop using the uplink if it happens to become marked free. An MS not allocated the uplink may perform a random access procedure on the uplink to gain access to talk, only if the uplink is marked as free.

On a channel used during a voice group call, the uplink power control shall only apply to the MS currently allocated that uplink, and the MS power control level ordered by the network shall be ignored by all other MSs listening to the downlink.

When performing a random access on a cell to gain access to the uplink of a channel used for a voice group call, until receiving the first dedicated power command from the network, the MS shall use the last received power level command as defined by the MS_TXPWR_MAX_CCH parameter broadcast on the BCCH of the cell, or if MS_TXPWR_MAX_CCH corresponds to a power control level not supported by the MS as defined by its power class in GSM 05.05, the MS shall act as though the closest supported power control level had been broadcast.

RF downlink power control will normally not be applied on channels used for a voice group call or voice broadcast.

5 Radio link failure

5.1 Criterion

The criterion for determining Radio Link Failure in the MS shall be based on the success rate of decoding messages on the downlink SACCH. For a circuit switched multislot configuration, only the main SACCH shall be used for determining Radio Link Failure.

For GPRS, Radio Link Failure is determined by the RLC/MAC protocol (see GSM 04.60).

5.2 MS procedure

The aim of determining radio link failure in the MS is to ensure that calls with unacceptable voice/data quality, which cannot be improved either by RF power control or handover, are either re-established or released in a defined manner. In general the parameters that control the forced release should be set such that the forced release will not normally occur until the call has degraded to a quality below that at which the majority of subscribers would have manually released. This ensures that, for example, a call on the edge of a radio coverage area, although of bad quality, can usually be completed if the subscriber wishes.

The radio link failure criterion is based on the radio link counter S. If the MS is unable to decode a SACCH message (BFI = 1),S is decreased by 1. In the case of a successful reception of a SACCH message (BFI = 0) S is increased by 2. In any case S shall not exceed the value of RADIO_LINK_TIMEOUT. If S reaches 0 a radio link failure shall be declared. The action to be taken is specified in GSM 04.08. The RADIO_LINK_TIMEOUT parameter is transmitted by each BSS in the BCCH data (see table 1).

The MS shall continue transmitting as normal on the uplink until S reaches 0.

The algorithm shall start after the assignment of a dedicated channel and S shall be initialized to RADIO_LINK_TIMEOUT.

The detailed operation shall be as follows:

- The radio link time-out algorithm shall be stopped at the reception of a channel change command.
- (Re-)initialization and start of the algorithm shall be done whenever the MS switches to a new channel (this includes the old channel in assignment and handover failure cases), at the latest when the main signalling link (see GSM 04.08) has been established.
- The RADIO_LINK_TIMEOUT value used at (re-)initialization shall be that used on the previous channel (in the Immediate Assignment case the value received on the BCCH), or the value received on SACCH if the MS has received a RADIO_LINK_TIMEOUT value on the new channel before the initialization.
- If the first RADIO_LINK_TIMEOUT value on the SACCH is received on the new channel after the initialization, the counter shall be re-initialized with the new value.

An MS listening to a voice group call or a voice broadcast, upon a downlink radio link failure shall return to idle mode and perform cell re-selection.

5.3 BSS procedure

The criteria for determining radio link failure in the BSS should be based upon either the error rate on the uplink SACCH(s) or on RXLEV/RXQUAL measurements of the MS. The exact criteria to be employed shall be determined by the network operator.

For channels used for a voice group call, the radio link failure procedures in the BSS shall be reset upon the re-allocation of the uplink to another MS. Upon a uplink radio failure, the network shall mark it as free, see subclause 4.8.

Whenever the uplink is not used, and for channels used for voice broadcast, the BSS radio link failure procedures shall not apply on that channel.

6 Idle mode tasks

6.1 Introduction

Whilst in idle mode, an MS shall implement the cell selection and re-selection procedures described in GSM 03.22. These procedures make use of measurements and sub-procedures described in this clause.

The procedures ensure that the MS is camped on a cell from which it can reliably decode downlink data and with which it has a high probability of communications on the uplink. Once the MS is camped on a cell, access to the network is allowed.

This clause makes use of terms defined in GSM 03.22.

The MS shall not use the discontinuous reception (DRX) mode of operation (i.e. powering itself down when it is not expecting paging messages from the network) while performing the cell selection algorithm defined in GSM 03.22. However use of powering down is permitted at all other times in idle mode.

For the purpose of cell selection and reselection, the MS shall be capable of detecting and synchronizing to a BCCH carrier and read the BCCH data at reference sensitivity level and reference interference levels as specified in GSM 05.05. An MS in idle mode shall always fulfil the performance requirement specified in GSM 05.05 at levels down to reference sensitivity level or reference interference level. The allowed error rates (see GSM 05.05) might impact the cell selection and reselection procedure, e.g. trigger cell reselection. Moreover, one consequence of the allowed error rates is that in the case of no frequency hopping and a TU3 (TU1.5 for DCS 1 800) propagation profile it can not be expected that an MS will respond to paging unless the received signal level is 2 dB higher than the specified reference level.

For the purposes of cell selection and reselection, the MS is required to maintain an average of received signal levels for all monitored frequencies. These quantities termed the "received level averages" (RLA_C), shall be unweighted averages of the received signal levels measured in dBm. The accuracy of the received signal level measurements for idle mode tasks shall be the same as for radio link measurements (see subclause 8.1.2).

The times given in subclauses 6.2, 6.3 and 6.6 refer to internal processes in the MS required to ensure that the MS camps as quickly as possible to the most appropriate cell.

For the cell selection, the MS shall be able to select the correct (fourth strongest) cell and be able to respond to paging on that cell within 30 seconds of switch on, when the three strongest cells are not suitable. This assumes a valid SIM with PIN disabled and ideal radio conditions.

The tolerance on all the timing requirements in clause 6 is ± 10 %, except for PENALTY_TIME where it is ± 2 s.

6.2 Measurements for normal cell selection

The measurements of this clause shall be performed by an MS which has no prior knowledge of which GSM or DCS 1 800 RF channels are BCCH carriers.

The MS shall search all RF channels in the system (124 for P-GSM, 174 for E-GSM, 194 for R-GSM, and 374 for DCS 1 800), take readings of received RF signal level on each RF channel, and calculate the RLA_C for each. The averaging is based on at least five measurement samples per RF carrier spread over 3 to 5 s, the measurement samples from the different RF carriers being spread evenly during this period.

A multi band MS shall search all channels within its bands of operation as specified above. The number of channels searched will be the sum of channels on each band of operation.

BCCH carriers can be identified by, for example, searching for frequency correction bursts. On finding a BCCH carrier, the MS shall attempt to synchronize to it and read the BCCH data.

The maximum time allowed for synchronization to a BCCH carrier is 0.5 s, and the maximum time allowed to read the BCCH data, when being synchronized to a BCCH carrier, is 1.9 s. . An exception is allowed for system information messages that are broadcast only once every n^{th} (n>1) occurrence of the 8 multiframes (see GSM 05.02). For these system information messages the allowed decoding time is extended according to the applied scheduling of the system information broadcast, i.e. n*1.9 s.

6.3 Measurements for stored list cell selection

The MS may include optional storage of BCCH carrier information when switched off as detailed in GSM 03.22. For example, the MS may store the BCCH carriers in use by the PLMN selected when it was last active in the GSM 900 or DCS 1 800 network. The BCCH list may include BCCH carriers from more than one band in a multi band operation PLMN. A MS may also store BCCH carriers for more than one PLMN which it has selected previously

(e.g. at national borders or when more than one PLMN serves a country), in which case the BCCH carrier lists must be kept quite separate.

The stored BCCH carrier information used by the MS may be derived by a variety of different methods. The MS may use the BA_RANGE information element, which, if transmitted in the channel release message (see GSM 04.08), indicates ranges of carriers which include the BCCH carriers in use over a wide area or even the whole PLMN. It should be noted that the BA(BCCH) list might only contain carriers in use in the vicinity of the cell on which it was broadcast, and therefore might not be appropriate if the MS is switched off and moved to a new location.

The BA_RANGE information element contains the Number of Ranges parameter (defined as NR) as well as NR sets of parameters RANGEi_LOWER and RANGEi_HIGHER. The MS should interpret these to mean that all the BCCH carriers of the network have ARFCNs in the following ranges:

Range*1* = ARFCN(RANGE*1*_LOWER) to ARFCN(RANGE*1*_HIGHER);
Range*2* = ARFCN(RANGE*2*_LOWER) to ARFCN(RANGE*2*_HIGHER);
Range*NR* = ARFCN(RANGE*NR*_LOWER) to ARFCN(RANGE*NR*_HIGHER).

If RANGEi_LOWER is greater than RANGEi_HIGHER, the range shall be considered cyclic and encompasses carriers with ARFCN from range RANGEi_LOWER to 1 023 and from 0 to RANGEi_HIGHER. If RANGEi_LOWER equals RANGEi_HIGHER then the range shall only consist of the carrier whose ARFCN is RANGEi_LOWER.

If an MS includes a stored BCCH carrier list of the selected PLMN it shall perform the same measurements as in subclause 6.2 except that only the BCCH carriers in the list need to be measured.

If stored list cell selection is not successful, then as defined in GSM 03.22, normal cell selection shall take place. Since information concerning a number of channels is already known to the MS, it may assign high priority to measurements on the strongest carriers from which it has not previously made attempts to obtain BCCH information, and omit repeated measurements on the known ones.

6.4 Criteria for cell selection and reselection

The path loss criterion parameter C1 used for cell selection and reselection is defined by:

C1 = (A - Max(B,0))

where

A = RLA_C - RXLEV_ACCESS_MIN
B = MS_TXPWR_MAX_CCH - P

except for the class 3 DCS 1 800 MS where:

B = MS_TXPWR_MAX_CCH + POWER OFFSET - P
RXLEV_ACCESS_MIN = Minimum received signal level at the MS required for access to the system.
MS_TXPWR_MAX_CCH = Maximum TX power level an MS may use when accessing the system until otherwise commanded.
POWER OFFSET = The power offset to be used in conjunction with the MS TXPWR MAX CCH parameter by the class 3 DCS 1 800 MS.
P = Maximum RF output power of the MS.

All values are expressed in dBm.

The path loss criterion (GSM 03.22) is satisfied if C1 > 0.

The reselection criterion C2 is used for cell reselection only and is defined by:

C2 = C1 + CELL_RESELECT_OFFSET - TEMPORARY OFFSET * H(PENALTY_TIME - T) for PENALTY_TIME <> 11111
C2 = C1 - CELL_RESELECT_OFFSET for PENALTY_TIME = 11111

where

For non-serving cells:

$H(x) = 0$ for $x < 0$
$= 1$ for $x \geq 0$

For serving cells:
$H(x) = 0$

T is a timer implemented for each cell in the list of strongest carriers (see subclause 6.6.1). T shall be started from zero at the time the cell is placed by the MS on the list of strongest carriers, except when the previous serving cell is placed on the list of strongest carriers at cell reselection. In this, case, T shall be set to the value of PENALTY_TIME (i.e. expired).

CELL_RESELECT_OFFSET applies an offset to the C2 reselection criterion for that cell.

NOTE: CELL_RESELECT_OFFSET may be used to give different priorities to different bands when multiband operation is used.

TEMPORARY_OFFSET applies a negative offset to C2 for the duration of PENALTY_TIME after the timer T has started for that cell.

PENALTY_TIME is the duration for which TEMPORARY_OFFSET applies The all ones bit pattern on the PENALTY_TIME parameter is reserved to change the sign of CELL_RESELECT_OFFSET and the value of TEMPORARY_OFFSET is ignored as indicated by the equation defining C2.

CELL_RESELECT_OFFSET, TEMPORARY_OFFSET and PENALTY_TIME are cell reselection parameters which are broadcast on the BCCH of the cell when CELL_RESELECT_PARAM_IND (see table 1) is set to 1. If CELL_RESELECT_PARAM_IND is set not received or received and set to 0, then the MS should take CELL_BAR_QUALIFY as 0, also in this case the cell reselection parameters take a value of 0 and therefore C2 = C1. The use of C2 is described in GSM 03.22.

These parameters are used to ensure that the MS is camped on the cell with which it has the highest probability of successful communication on uplink and downlink.

6.5 Downlink signalling failure

The downlink signalling failure criterion is based on the downlink signalling failure counter DSC. When the MS camps on a cell, DSC shall be initialized to a value equal to the nearest integer to 90/N where N is the BS_PA_MFRMS parameter for that cell (see GSM 05.02). Thereafter, whenever the MS attempts to decode a message in its paging subchannel; if a message is successfully decoded (BFI = 0) DSC is increased by 1, however never beyond the initial value, otherwise DSC is decreased by 4. When DSC ≤ 0, a downlink signalling failure shall be declared.

For GPRS, an MS not in packet transfer mode shall follow the same procedure. The counter DSC shall be initialized each time the MS leaves packet transfer mode. In case DRX period split is supported, DSC shall be initialized to a value equal to the nearest integer to max(10, 90/64*SPLIT_PG_CYCLE), where SPLIT_PG_CYCLE is an MS parameter defined at GPRS attach (see GSM 05.02). If DRX is not used, SPLIT_PG_CYCLE shall be replaced by 768 for PCCCH or 256 for CCCH in this formula.

NOTE: The network sends the paging subchannel for a given MS every BS_PA_MFRMS multiframes or, in case DRX period split is supported, every 64/SPLIT_PG_CYCLE multiframes. The requirement for network transmission on the paging subchannel is specified in GSM 04.08 or GSM 04.60. The MS is required to attempt to decode a message every time its paging subchannel is sent.

A downlink signalling failure shall result in cell reselection.

6.6 Measurements for Cell Reselection

Upon completion of cell selection and when starting the cell reselection tasks, the MS shall synchronize to and read the BCCH information for the 6 strongest non-serving carriers (in the BA) as quickly as possible within the times specified in subclause 6.6.1. For multi band MSs the strongest non-serving carriers may belong to different frequency bands.
If system information message type 2 ter is used in the serving cell, and the MS has decoded all relevant serving cell

BCCH data, except system information message 2 ter, then the MS shall start cell reselection measurements based on the know part of the BA, until system information message 2 ter is decoded and the full BA can be used.

6.6.1 Monitoring of received signal level and BCCH data

Whilst in idle mode an MS shall continue to monitor all BCCH carriers as indicated by the BCCH allocation (BA - See table 1). A running average of received signal level (RLA_C) in the preceding 5 to:

Max {5 , ((5 * N + 6) DIV 7) * BS_PA_MFRMS / 4}

seconds shall be maintained for each carrier in the BCCH allocation. N is the number of non-serving cell BCCH carriers in BA and the parameter BS_PA_MFRMS is defined in GSM 05.02.

The same number of measurement samples shall be taken for all non-serving cell BCCH carriers of the BA list, and the samples allocated to each carrier shall as far as possible be uniformly distributed over each evaluation period. At least 5 received signal level measurement samples are required per RLA_C value. New sets of RLA_C values shall be calculated as often as possible.

For the serving cell, received signal level measurement samples shall be taken at least for each paging block of the MS. The RLA_C shall be a running average determined using samples collected over a period of 5 s to Max {5s, five consecutive paging blocks of that MS}. The samples shall as far as possible be uniformly distributed over each evaluation period. At least 5 received signal level measurement samples are required per RLA_C value. New RLA_C values shall be calculated as often as possible.

The list of the 6 strongest non-serving carriers shall be updated at least as often as the duration of the running average defined for measurements on the BCCH allocation and may be updated more frequently.

In order to minimize power consumption, MS that employ DRX (i.e. power down when paging blocks are not due) should monitor the received signal levels of non-serving cell BCCH carriers during the frames of the paging block that they are required to listen to. The MS shall include the BCCH carrier of the current serving cell (i.e. the cell the MS is camped on) in this measurement routine. Received signal level measurement samples can thus be taken on several non-serving cell BCCH carriers and on the serving carrier during each paging block.

The MS shall attempt to decode the full BCCH data of the serving cell at least every 30 seconds.

The MS shall attempt to decode the BCCH data block that contains the parameters affecting cell reselection for each of the 6 strongest non-serving cell BCCH carriers at least every 5 minutes. When the MS recognizes that a new BCCH carrier has become one of the 6 strongest, the BCCH data shall be decoded for the new carrier within 30 seconds.

The MS shall attempt to check the BSIC for each of the 6 strongest non-serving cell BCCH carriers at least every 30 seconds, to confirm that it is monitoring the same cell. If a change of BSIC is detected then the carrier shall be treated as a new carrier and the BCCH data re-determined.

When requested by the user, the MS shall determine which PLMNs are available (Manual Mode) or available and allowable (Automatic Mode) (see GSM 03.22) within 15 seconds (for GSM 900) or 20 seconds (for DCS 1 800). A multi band MS shall perform the same procedures in all bands of operation within the sum of time constraints in the respective band of operation.

In both cases, this monitoring shall be done so as to minimize interruptions to the monitoring of the PCH.

The maximum time allowed for synchronization to a BCCH carrier is 0,5 s, and the maximum time allowed to read the BCCH data, when being synchronized to a BCCH carrier, is 1,9 s. . An exception is allowed for system information messages that are broadcast only once every n^{th} (n>1) occurrence of the 8 multiframes (see GSM 05.02). For these system information messages the allowed decoding time is extended according to the applied scheduling of the system information broadcast, i.e. n*1.9 s.

6.6.2 Path loss criteria and timings for cell re-selection

The MS is required to perform the following measurements (see GSM 03.22) to ensure that the path loss criterion to the serving cell is acceptable.

At least every 5 s the MS shall calculate the value of C1 and C2 for the serving cell and re-calculate C1 and C2 values for non serving cells (if necessary). The MS shall then check whether:

i) The path loss criterion (C1) for current serving cell falls below zero for a period of 5 seconds. This indicates that the path loss to the cell has become too high.

ii) The calculated value of C2 for a non-serving suitable cell exceeds the value of C2 for the serving cell for a period of 5 seconds, except;

   a) in the case of the new cell being in a different location area or, for a GPRS MS, in a different routing area or always for a GPRS MS in ready state in which case the C2 value for the new cell shall exceed the C2 value of the serving cell by at least CELL_RESELECT_HYSTERESIS dB as defined by the BCCH data from the current serving cell, for a period of 5 seconds;

   or

   b) in case of a cell reselection occurring within the previous 15 seconds in which case the C2 value for the new cell shall exceed the C2 value of the serving cell by at least 5 dB for a period of 5 seconds.

   This indicates that it is a better cell.

Cell reselection for any other reason (see GSM 03.22) shall take place immediately, but the cell that the MS was camped on shall not be returned to within 5 seconds if another suitable cell can be found. If valid RLA_C values are not available, the MS shall wait until these values are available and then perform the cell reselection if it is still required. The MS may accelerate the measurement procedure within the requirements in subclause 6.6.1 to minimize the cell reselection delay.

If no suitable cell is found within 10 seconds, the cell selection algorithm of GSM 03.22 shall be performed. Since information concerning a number of channels is already known to the MS, it may assign high priority to measurements on the strongest carriers from which it has not previously made attempts to obtain BCCH information, and omit repeated measurements on the known ones.

6.7 Release of TCH and SDCCH

6.7.1 Normal case

When the MS releases all TCHs or SDCCH and returns to idle mode or packet idle mode, it shall, as quickly as possible, camp on the cell whose channel has just been released. If the full (P)BCCH data for that cell was not decoded in the preceding 30s, the MS shall then attempt to decode the full (P)BCCH data. Until the MS has decoded the (P)BCCH data required for determining the paging group, it shall also monitor all paging blocks on timeslot 0 of the BCCH carrier or, for GPRS if PCCCH exists, on the PDCH indicated on BCCH for possible paging messages that might address it. If the MS receives a page before having decoded the full (P)BCCH data for the cell, the MS shall store the page and respond once the full (P)BCCH data has been decoded, provided that the cell is not barred and the MS's access class is allowed.

If at the release of the connection the MS has the knowledge that the cell whose channel is being released is not suitable (see GSM 03.22), the MS is allowed to camp on any suitable cell.

NOTE: The received signal level measurements on surrounding cells made during the last 5 seconds on the TCH or SDCCH may be averaged and used, where possible, to speed up the process. However, it should be noted that the received signal level monitoring while on the TCH or SDCCH is on carriers in BA (SACCH), while the carriers to be monitored for cell reselection are in BA (BCCH) or BA (GPRS).

After decoding the full (P)BCCH data the MS shall perform cell reselection as specified in GSM 03.22.

6.7.2 Call re-establishment

In the event of a radio link failure, call re-establishment may be attempted (according to the procedure in GSM 04.08). The MS shall perform the following algorithm to determine which cell to use for the call re-establishment attempt.

i) The received signal level measurement samples taken on the carriers indicated in the BA (SACCH) received on the serving cell and on the serving cell BCCH carrier in the last 5 seconds shall be averaged, and the carrier with the highest average received signal level with a permitted NCC as indicated on the SACCH of the serving cell (see subclause 7.2) shall be taken.

ii) On this carrier the MS shall attempt to decode the BCCH data block containing the parameters affecting cell selection.

iii) If the parameter C1 is greater than zero, it is part of the selected PLMN, the cell is not barred, and call re-establishment is allowed, call re-establishment shall be attempted on this cell.

iv) If the MS is unable to decode the BCCH data block or if the conditions in iii) are not met, the carrier with the next highest average received signal level with a permitted NCC shall be taken, and the MS shall repeat steps ii) and iii) above.

v) If the cells with the 6 strongest average received signal level values with a permitted NCC have been tried but cannot be used, the call re-establishment attempt shall be abandoned, and the algorithm of subclause 6.7.1 shall be performed.

The MS is under no circumstances allowed to access a cell to attempt call re-establishment later than 20 seconds after the detection within the MS of the radio link failure causing the call re-establishment attempt. In the case where the 20 seconds elapses without a successful call re-establishment the call re-establishment attempt shall be abandoned, and the algorithm of subclause 6.7.1 shall be performed.

Call re-establishment shall not be applied for voice group calls.

6.8 Abnormal cases and emergency calls

When in the limited service state (see GSM 03.22) the aim is to gain normal service rapidly and the following tasks shall be performed, depending on the conditions, as given in the table below:

a) The MS shall monitor the received signal level of all RF channels within its bands of operation (124 for P-GSM, 174 for E-GSM, 194 for R-GSM, and 374 for DCS 1 800), and search for a BCCH carrier which has C1 > 0 and which is not barred. When such a carrier is found, the MS shall camp on that cell, irrespective of the PLMN identity.

b) The MS shall search the strongest RF channels to determine which PLMNs are available (Manual Mode) or available and allowable (Automatic Mode). This information shall be processed according to the PLMN selection algorithm defined in GSM 03.22.

c) The MS shall perform cell reselection at least among the cells of the PLMN of the cell on which the MS has camped, according to the algorithm of GSM 03.22, except that a zero value of CELL_RESELECT_HYSTERESIS shall be used.

Condition			**Tasks to be performed as a minimum:**		
SIM Present	**Other**	**MS camped on a cell**	**a)**	**b)**	**c)**
X	X	No	Yes	No	No
No	X	Yes	No	No	Yes
Yes	"IMSI Unknown", "illegal MS"	Yes	No	No	Yes
Yes	No suitable cell of selected PLMN or "PLMN not allowed"	Yes	No	Yes	Yes

X = "Don't care state"

In this mode, only emergency calls may be made (and these may only be made if task c) was being performed). Powering down of the MS is permitted.

7 Network pre-requisites

7.1 BCCH carriers

The BCCH carrier shall be continuously transmitted on all timeslots and without variation of RF level. However, the RF power level may be ramped down between timeslots to facilitate switching between RF transmitters. On the PCH the network shall send valid layer 3 messages according to GSM 04.08. Unused signalling blocks on the CCCH/BCCH shall contain L2 fill frames. Other unused timeslots shall transmit dummy bursts.

NOTE: This BCCH organization enables MS to measure the received signal level from surrounding cells by tuning and listening to their BCCH carriers. Providing that an MS tunes to the list of BCCH carriers indicated by the network it will, providing the list is sufficiently complete, have listened to all possible surrounding cells, i.e. the surrounding cell list for handover purposes is effectively defined by the MS. Refer to GSM 03.22 for definitions of the BCCH carrier lists. This can be achieved without inter-base station synchronization.

7.2 Identification of surrounding BSS for handover measurements

It is essential for the MS to identify which surrounding BSS is being measured in order to ensure reliable handover. Because of frequency re-use with small cluster sizes, the BCCH carrier frequency may not be sufficient to uniquely identify a surrounding cell, i.e. the cell in which the MS is situated may have more than one surrounding cell using the same BCCH frequency. Thus it is necessary for the MS to synchronize to and demodulate surrounding BCCH carriers and identify the base station identification code (BSIC). The MS shall be able to perform this task at levels down to the reference sensitivity level or reference interference levels as specified in GSM 05.05.

The MS shall use at least 4 spare frames per SACCH block period for the purpose of decoding the BSICs (e.g. in the case of TCH/F, the four idle frames per SACCH block period). These frames are termed "search" frames.

A 6 bit Base Station Identity Code (BSIC), as defined in GSM 03.03, shall be transmitted on each BCCH carrier. The PLMN part of the BSIC can be regarded as a "PLMN colour code".

The MS shall demodulate the SCH on the BCCH carrier of each surrounding cell and decode the BSIC as often as possible, and as a minimum at least once every 10 seconds. A list containing information about the timing of the surrounding cells at the accuracy required for accessing a cell (see GSM 05.10) including the absolute times derived from the parameters T1, T2, T3 shall be kept by the MS. This information may be used to schedule the decoding of BSIC and shall be used in connection with handover in order to keep the switching time at a minimum.

If, after averaging measurement results over 2 SACCH block periods, the MS detects one or more BCCH carriers, among the 6 strongest, whose BSICs are not currently being assessed, then the MS shall as a matter of priority attempt to decode their BSICs.

In the case of a multi band MS, the MS shall attempt to decode the BSIC, if any BCCH carrier with unknown BSIC is detected among the number of strongest BCCH carriers in each band as indicated by the Multiband Reporting parameter.

Thus an MS shall, for a period of up to 5 seconds, devote all search frames to attempting to decode these BSICs. If this fails then the MS shall return to confirming existing BSICs. Having re-confirmed existing BSICs, if there are still BCCH carriers, among the six strongest, with unknown BSICs, then the decoding of these shall again be given priority for a further period of up to 5 seconds.

The MS shall report a new strongest cell in the measurement report at the latest 5 s after a new strongest cell (which is part of the BA(SACCH)) has been activated under the following network conditions: Initial serving cell at RXLEV= -70 dBm, with 6 neighbours at RXLEV= -75 dBm. Then the new BCCH carrier is switched on at RXLEV= -60 dBm.

NOTE: Because of test equipment limitations it is acceptable to activate the new carrier to replace one of the 6 neighbours.

If either no BSIC can be demodulated on a surrounding cell BCCH carrier, or the NCC part of the BSIC is not one of the permitted NCCs, then the received signal level measurements on that channel shall be discarded. The permitted NCCs are defined by the NCC_PERMITTED parameter transmitted in the BCCH data. This is an 8 bit map that relates to the NCC part of BSIC. (e.g. NCC_PERMITTED = 01101001, defines that only carriers having a BSIC with the NCC part = 000, 011, 101,110 shall be reported).

If a change of BSIC is detected on a carrier, then any existing received signal level measurement shall be discarded and a new averaging period commenced. This occurs when the MS moves away from one surrounding cell and closer to another co-channel cell.

If the BSIC cannot be decoded at the next available opportunities re-attempts shall be made to decode this BSIC. If the BSIC is not decoded for more than three successive attempts it will be considered lost and any existing received signal level measurement shall be discarded.

Details of the synchronization mechanisms appear in GSM 05.10. The procedure for monitoring surrounding BTS with respect to HO measurement shall begin at least at the time of assignment of a dedicated channel.

When a BCCH carrier is found to be no longer among the reported, timing and BSIC information shall be retained for at least 10 seconds. (This is in case a handover is commanded to this cell just after the MS stops reporting RXLEV and RXQUAL on this cell).

8 Radio link measurements

Radio link measurements are used in the handover and RF power control processes.

In particular, radio-subsystem directed handover is defined as a change of channel(s) during a call either because of degradation of the quality of one or more of the current serving channel(s), or because of the availability of other channel(s) which can allow communication at a lower TX power level, or to prevent a MS grossly exceeding the planned cell boundaries.

Additional measurements, so called Extended measurements, can e.g. be used for frequency planning purposes.

The measurements are made over each SACCH multiframe, which is 104 TDMA frames (480 ms) for a TCH and 102 TDMA frames (470,8 ms) for an SDCCH.

8.1 Signal level

8.1.1 General

The received signal level may be employed as a criterion in the RF power control and handover processes.

8.1.2 Physical parameter

The R.M.S received signal level at the receiver input shall be measured by the MS and the BSS over the full range of -110 dBm to -48 dBm with an absolute accuracy of ± 4 dB from -110 dBm to -70 dBm under normal conditions and ± 6 dB over the full range under both normal and extreme conditions.

If the received signal level falls below the reference sensitivity level for the type of MS or BSS, then the measured level shall be within the range allowing for the absolute accuracy specified above. In case the upper limit of this range is below the reference sensitivity level for the type of MS or BSS, then the upper limit shall be considered as equal to the reference sensitivity level.

The relative accuracy shall be as follows:

If signals of level x1 and x2 dBm are received (where x1 ≤ x2) and levels y1 and y2 dBm respectively are measured, if x2 - x1 < 20 dB and x1 is not below the reference sensitivity level, then y1 and y2 shall be such that:

(x2 - x1) - a ≤ y2 - y1 ≤ (x2 - x1 + b) if the measurements are on the same or on different RF channel within the same frequency band;

and

(x2 - x1) - c ≤ y2 - y1 ≤(x2 - x1 + d) if the measurements are on different frequency bands:

a, b, c and d are in dB and depend on the value of x1 as follows:

	a	b	c	d
x1 ≥ s+14	2	2	4	4
s+14 > x1 ≥ s+1	3	2	5	4
s+1 > x1	4	2	6	4

For single band MS or BTS and measurements between ARFN in the same band for a multiband

MS or BTS;

s = reference sensitivity level as specified in GSM 05.05.

For measurements between ARFCN in different bands;

s = the reference sensitivity level as specified in GSM 05.05 for the band including x1.

At extreme temperature conditions an extra 2 dB shall be added to c and d in above table.

The selectivity of the received signal level measurement shall be as follows:

- for adjacent (200 kHz) channel ≥ 16 dB;
- for adjacent (400 kHz) channel ≥ 48 dB;
- for adjacent (600 kHz) channel ≥ 56 dB.

The selectivity shall be met using random, continuous, GSM-modulated signals with the wanted signal at the level 20 dB above the reference sensitivity level.

8.1.3 Statistical parameters

For each channel, the measured parameters (RXLEV) shall be the average of the received signal level measurement samples in dBm taken on that channel within the reporting period of length one SACCH multiframe defined in 8.4. In averaging, measurements made during previous reporting periods shall always be discarded.

When assigned a TCH or SDCCH the MS shall make a received signal level measurement:

- in every TDMA frame on at least one of the BCCH carriers indicated in the BCCH allocation (BA), one after another. Optionally, measurements during up to 4 frames per SACCH multiframe may be omitted.

NOTE: These four frames are those immediately preceding the search frames, in order to allow the MS to search for BCCH synchronization over a full TDMA frame.

- for each assigned bi-directional channel, on all bursts of the associated physical channel (see GSM 05.02), including those of the SACCH. If frequency hopping is being used on the associated physical channel and if, in the BCCH Cell Options, the Power Control Indicator PWRC is set, measurements on the bursts on the BCCH frequency shall not be used in the RXLEV averaging process.

Unless otherwise specified by the operator, for any TCH or SDCCH assigned to an MS, the BSS shall make a received signal level measurement on all time slots of the associated physical channel including those of the SACCH, but excluding the idle timeslots.

8.1.4 Range of parameter

The measured signal level shall be mapped to an RXLEV value between 0 and 63, as follows:

RXLEV	0	=	less than		-110 dBm.
RXLEV	1	=	-110 dBm	to	-109 dBm.
RXLEV	2	=	-109 dBm	to	-108 dBm.
		:			
		:			
RXLEV	62	=	-49 dBm	to	-48 dBm.
RXLEV	63	=	greater than		-48 dBm.

6 bits are required to define RXLEV for each carrier measured.

8.2 Signal quality

8.2.1 General

The received signal quality shall be employed as a criterion in the RF power control and handover processes.

8.2.2 Physical parameter

The received signal quality shall be measured by the MS and BSS in a manner that can be related to an equivalent average BER before channel decoding (i.e. chip error ratio), assessed over the reporting period of 1 SACCH block.

For example, the measurement may be made as part of the channel equalization process, decoding process, pseudo-error rate measurement etc.

8.2.3 Statistical parameters

For each channel, the measured parameters (RXQUAL) shall be the received signal quality, averaged on that channel over the reporting period of length one SACCH multiframe defined in subclause 8.4. In averaging, measurements made during previous reporting periods shall always be discarded.

Contrary to RXLEV measurements, in calculating RXQUAL values, measurements on bursts on the BCCH carrier shall always be included in the averaging process.

8.2.4 Range of parameter

When the quality is assessed over the full-set and sub-set of frames defined in subclause 8.4, eight levels of RXQUAL are defined and shall be mapped to the equivalent BER before channel decoding as follows:

RXQUAL_0			BER	<	0,2 %	Assumed value = 0,14 %
RXQUAL_1	0,2 %	<	BER	<	0,4 %	Assumed value = 0,28 %
RXQUAL_2	0,4 %	<	BER	<	0,8 %	Assumed value = 0,57 %
RXQUAL_3	0,8 %	<	BER	<	1,6 %	Assumed value = 1,13 %
RXQUAL_4	1,6 %	<	BER	<	3,2 %	Assumed value = 2,26 %
RXQUAL_5	3,2 %	<	BER	<	6,4 %	Assumed value = 4,53 %
RXQUAL_6	6,4 %	<	BER	<	12,8 %	Assumed value = 9,05 %
RXQUAL_7	12,8 %	<	BER			Assumed value = 18,10 %

The assumed values may be employed in any averaging process applied to RXQUAL.

The BER values used to define a quality band are the estimated error probabilities before channel decoding, averaged over the full set or sub set of TDMA frames as defined in subclause 8.4. The accuracy to which an MS shall be capable of estimating the error probabilities when on a TCH under static channel conditions is given in the following table. Note the exception of subclause 8.4 on data channels using interleaving depth 19 and on half rate speech channel.

Quality Band	Range of actual BER	Probability that the correct RXQUAL band is reported by MS shall exceed		
		Full rate Channel	Half rate Channel	DTX Mode
RXQUAL_0	Less than 0,1 %	90 %	90 %	65 %
RXQUAL_1	0,26 % to 0,30 %	75 %	60 %	35 %
RXQUAL_2	0,51 % to 0,64 %	85 %	70 %	45 %
RXQUAL_3	1,0 % to 1,3 %	90 %	85 %	45 %
RXQUAL_4	1,9 % to 2,7 %	90 %	85 %	60 %
RXQUAL_5	3,8 % to 5,4 %	95 %	95 %	70 %
RXQUAL_6	7,6 % to 11,0 %	95 %	95 %	80 %
RXQUAL_7	Greater than 15,0 %	95 %	95 %	85 %

NOTE 1: For the full rate channel RXQUAL_FULL is based on 104 TDMA frames.
NOTE 2: For the half rate channel RXQUAL_FULL is based on 52 TDMA frames.
NOTE 3: For the DTX mode RXQUAL_SUB is based on 12 TDMA frames.

The accuracy to which an MS shall be capable of estimating the error probabilities when on a TCH under TU50 channel conditions is given in the following table. Note the exception of subclause 8.4 on data channels using interleaving depth 19 and on half rate speech channel.

Range of actual BER	Expected RXQUAL_FULL	Probability that expected RXQUAL_FULL is reported shall exceed
Less than 0,1 %	RXQUAL_0/1	85 %
0,26 % to 0,30 %	RXQUAL_1/0/2	85 %
0,51 % to 0,64 %	RXQUAL_2/1/3	85 %
1,0 % to 1,3 %	RXQUAL_3/2/4	90 %
1,9 % to 2,7 %	RXQUAL_4/3/5	90 %
3,8 % to 5,4 %	RXQUAL_5/4/6	90 %
7,6 % to 11,0 %	RXQUAL_6/5/7	90 %
Greater than 15,0 %	RXQUAL_7/6	90 %

It should be noted that in the testing, the System Simulator (SS) or (BSSTE) Base Station System Test Equipment will have to measure the average error rate over a large number of TDMA frames.

8.3 Aspects of discontinuous transmission (DTX)

When DTX is employed on a TCH, not all TDMA frames may be transmitted, however, the following subset shall always be transmitted, and hence can be employed to assess quality and signal level during DTX.

Type of channel	TDMA frame subset always to be transmitted TDMA frame number (FN) modulo 104
TCH/F	52, 53, 54, 55, 56, 57, 58, 59
TCH/HS,subchannel 0	0, 2, 4, 6, 52, 54, 56, 58
TCH/HS,subchannel 1	14, 16, 18, 20, 66, 68, 70, 72
TCH/H,data,subchannel 0,uplink	52, 54, 56, 58, 60, 62, 65, 67, 69, 71
TCH/H,data,subchannel 0,downlink	56, 58, 60, 62, 65, 67, 69, 71, 73, 75
TCH/H,data,subchannel 1,uplink	70, 72, 74, 76, 79, 81, 83, 85, 87, 89
TCH/H,data,subchannel 1,downlink	66, 68, 70, 72, 74, 76, 79, 81, 83, 85

On any TCH this subset of TDMA frames is always used for transmission during DTX. For speech, when no signalling or speech is to be transmitted these TDMA frames are occupied by the SID (Silence Descriptor) speech frame, see GSM 06.12 and TSM GSM 06.31 for detailed specification of the SID frame and its transmission requirements. In other cases when no information is required to be transmitted, e.g. on data channels, the L2 fill frame (see GSM 04.06 subclause 5.4.2.3) shall be transmitted as a FACCH in the TDMA frame subset always to be transmitted.

On the SDCCH and on the half rate traffic channel TCH/H in signalling only mode DTX is not allowed. In these cases and on the TCH/F in signalling only mode when DTX is not used, the same L2 fill frame shall be transmitted in case there is nothing else to transmit.

8.4 Measurement reporting

8.4.1 Measurement reporting for the MS on a TCH

For a TCH, the reporting period of length 104 TDMA frames (480 ms) is defined in terms of TDMA frame numbers (FN) as follows:

Timeslot number (TN)			TDMA frame number (FN) modulo 104	
TCH/F	**TCH/H,subch.0**	**TCH/H,subch.1**	**Reporting period**	**SACCH Message block**
0	0 and 1		0 to 103	12, 38, 64, 90
1		0 and 1	13 to 12	25, 51, 77, 103
2	2 and 3		26 to 25	38, 64, 90, 12
3		2 and 3	39 to 38	51, 77, 103, 25
4	4 and 5		52 to 51	64, 90, 12, 38
5		4 and 5	65 to 64	77, 103, 25, 51
6	6 and 7		78 to 77	90, 12, 38, 64
7		6 and 7	91 to 90	103, 25, 51, 77

For a multislot configuration, the reporting period and SACCH Message block for each timeslot is defined as for TCH/F for TN = 0.

When on a TCH, the MS shall assess during the reporting period and transmit to the BSS in the next SACCH message block the following:

- RXLEV for the BCCH carrier of the 6 cells with the highest RXLEV among those with known and allowed NCC part of BSIC. For a multi band MS the number of cells, for each frequency band supported, which shall be included is specified in subclause 8.4.3.

NOTE 1: Since there are 104 TDMA frames in each SACCH multiframe (and measurement in 4 frames is optional), the number of samples on each BCCH carrier will depend on the number of carriers defined in the BCCH Allocation (BA) and may be different. The following table gives examples of this.

Number of BCCH carriers in BCCH Allocation	Number of samples per carrier in SACCH multiframe
32	3-4
16	6-7
10	10-11
8	12-13
:	:
:	:

These figures are increased if the MS is able to make measurements on more than one BCCH carrier during each TDMA frame.

- RXLEV_FULL and RXQUAL_FULL:
  RXLEV and RXQUAL for the full set of TCH and SACCH TDMA frames. The full set of TDMA frames is either 100 (i.e. 104 - 4 idle) frames for a full rate TCH or 52 frames for a half-rate TCH.

- RXLEV_SUB and RXQUAL_SUB:
  RXLEV and RXQUAL for the subset of 4 SACCH frames and the SID TDMA frames/L2 fill frames defined in 8.3. In case of data traffic channels TCH/F9.6, TCH/F4.8, TCH/H4.8 and TCH/H2.4, the RXQUAL_SUB report shall include measurements on the TDMA frames given in the table of subclause 8.3 only if L2 fill frames have been received as FACCH frames at the corresponding frame positions. If no FACCH frames have been received at the corresponding frame positions, the RXQUAL_SUB report shall include measurements on the 4 SACCH frames only. The performance requirements of subclause 8.2.4 do not apply in this case for RXQUAL_SUB. In case of half rate speech channel TCH/HS, if an SID frame or a speech frame as defined in subclause 8.3 is replaced by an FACCH frame, the RXQUAL measurement on these frames shall be excluded from the RXQUAL

SUB report. The performance requirements of subclause 8.2.4 do not apply in this case for RXQUAL SUB. In case of half rate traffic channel TCH/H in signalling only mode, -SUB values are set equal to the -FULL values in the SACCH message, since DTX is not allowed in this case.

NOTE 2: If measurement on the BCCH carrier is not used, the number of TDMA frames used in the RXLEV averaging process may be lower than the number of TDMA frames in the set see subclause 8.1.3.

In case of a multislot configuration, the MS shall report the following according to the definition above:

- on the main SACCH: the RXLEV values from the adjecent cells, RXLEV_FULL and RXLEV_SUB from the main channel and the worst RXQUAL_FULL values and RXQUAL_SUB values from the main channel and the unidirectional channels;

- on each other bi-directional SACCH: the RXLEV values from the adjecent cells, RXLEV_FULL, RXLEV_SUB, RXQUAL_FULL and RXQUAL_SUB from the corresponding channel.

8.4.2 Measurement reporting for the MS on a SDCCH

For a SDCCH, the reporting period of length 102 TDMA frames (470.8 ms) is defined in terms of TDMA frame numbers (FN) as follows:

	TDMA frame number (FN) modulo 102
SDCCH/8	12 to 11
SDCCH/4	37 to 36

NOTE 1: Some SDCCH data or TCH speech, data or SID message blocks are spread over two reporting periods. In these cases, the RXLEV and/or RXQUAL information from the SDCCH or TCH message blocks may either be sent as part of the measurement report of the second period, or shared between the reports of the two periods.

When on a SDCCH, the MS shall assess during the reporting period and transmit to the BSS in the next SACCH message block the following:

- RXLEV for the BCCH carrier of the 6 cells with the highest RXLEV among those with known and allowed NCC part of BSIC. For a multi band MS the number of cells, for each frequency band supported, which shall be included is specified in subclause 8.4.3.

NOTE 2: With only 102 TDMA frames in each SACCH multiframe, the number of samples used to calculate RXLEV per BCCH carrier may be slightly different from the case of TCH described above.

- RXLEV and RXQUAL for the full set of 12 (8 SDCCH and 4 SACCH) frames within the reporting period. As DTX is not allowed on the SDCCH, -SUB values are set equal to the -FULL values in the SACCH message.

NOTE 3: If measurement on the BCCH carrier is not used, the number of TDMA frames used in the RXLEV averaging process may be lower than the number of TDMA frames in the full set see subclause 8.1.3.

8.4.3 Additional cell reporting requirements for multi band MS

For a multi band MS the number of cells, for each frequency band supported, which shall be included in the measurement report is indicated by the parameter, MULTIBAND_REPORTING. The meaning of different values of the parameter is specified as follows:

Value	Meaning
00	Normal reporting of the six strongest cells, with known and allowed NCC part of BSIC, irrespective of the band used.
01	The MS shall report the strongest cell, with known and allowed NCC part of BSIC, in each of the frequency bands in the BA list, excluding the frequency band of the serving cell. The remaining positions in the measurement report shall be used for reporting of cells in the band of the serving cell. If there are still remaining positions, these shall be used to report the next strongest identified cells in the other bands irrespective of the band used.
10	The MS shall report the two strongest cells, with known and allowed NCC part of BSIC, in each of the frequency bands in the BA list, excluding the frequency band of the serving cell. The remaining positions in the measurement report shall be used for reporting of cells in the band of the serving cell. If there are still remaining positions, these shall be used to report the next strongest identified cells in the other bands irrespective of the band used.
11	The MS shall report the three strongest cells, with known and allowed NCC part of BSIC, in each of the frequency bands in the BA list, excluding the frequency band of the serving cell. The remaining positions in the measurement report shall be used for reporting of cells in the band of the serving cell. If there are still remaining positions, these shall be used to report the next strongest identified cells in the other bands irrespective of the band used.

8.4.4 Common aspects for the MS on a TCH or a SDCCH

Whether the MS is on a TCH or a SDCCH, if the next SACCH message block is used for a different Layer 3 message, the averaged data which would otherwise be sent in that block is discarded and a new average started for the current block. I.e., any SACCH message will report the average data for the previous reporting period only.

The MS shall also transmit a bit (DTX_USED) in the next SACCH message block, which indicates whether or not it has employed DTX during the reporting period. This bit shall be set even if just one burst in a TDMA frame in the reporting period was not transmitted due to DTX.

NOTE: A speech or user data frame subject to DTX may cross the "border" between two reporting periods, in which case both of the associated SACCH message blocks will have the DTX_USED flag set.

The measurements in the MS shall be based on the current BA list and the current NCC_PERMITTED (see table 1), available at the beginning of the reporting period. At the transition from idle mode to a TCH or a SDCCH the current BA list is the BA(BCCH), later the latest received complete BA(SACCH). A complete BA(SACCH) for a MS shall be that contained in SI 5 and additionally SI 5bis if the EXT-IND bit in the Neighbour Cell Description information element in both the SI 5 and SI 5bis messages indicates that each information element only carries part of the BA. If a SI 5ter message is subsequently received and not ignored (see GSM 04.08) the BA(SACCH) shall be modified accordingly.

At the transition from idle mode to a TCH or a SDCCH the current NCC is the NCC_PERMITTED received on the BCCH, later the latest NCC_PERMITTED received on the SACCH. The measurement process on carriers contained in both lists is, therefore, continuous.

If the current BA list does not refer to the serving cell, e.g. after a handover, this shall be indicated and no measurement values for cells in the BA list shall be reported.

If the MS returns to the previous cell after a failure of the handover procedure the description above applies. As a consequence, a BA list (and/or NCC_PERMITTED) received on the SAACCH in the cell to which the handover failed shall be regarded as the current ones, which may lead to interruptions in the measurement reporting as the BA list does not refer to the serving cell. As an option, the MS may in this case remember the last received BA list and NCC_PERMITTED in the old cell and regard those as the current ones when returning.

8.4.5 Measurement reporting for the BSS

Unless otherwise specified by the operator, the BSS shall make the same RXLEV (full and sub) and RXQUAL (full and sub) assessments as described for the MS for all TCH's and SDCCH's assigned to an MS, using the associated reporting

periods. These values, together with the reported values from the MS, shall be transmitted to the BSC as described in the GSM 08.58.

8.4.6 Extended measurement reporting

When on a TCH or SDCCH, the mobile station may receive an Extended Measurement Order (EMO) message. The mobile station shall then, during one reporting period, perform received signal level measurements according to the frequency list contained in the EMO message. BSIC decoding is not required for these frequencies. The mobile station shall in the next SACCH message block transmit the Extended Measurement Report message, containing the following:

- RXLEV (as defined in subclause 8.1.4) for the carriers specified by the last received EMO message. If the EMO contains more than 21 carriers, only the 21 first carriers in the sorted EXTENDED MEASUREMENT FREQUENCY LIST (in the EMO) are measured and reported.

- DTX USED, as defined in subclause 8.4.4.

NOTE : the position of the signal strength measurement samples performed by the mobile station, and the duration of these samples are not known in a TDMA frame. Consequently, in case the signal level on the carrier the MS has to monitor is not constant, the MS will report as the RXLEV value, the signal strength measurements performed during its sampling period. This value can be different from the mean value of the signal level on the whole frame.

If extended measurements are not possible due to the requirements on reporting of normal measurements (see GSM 04.08), the extended measurements shall be suppressed and scheduled at the next possible opportunity. If reporting is not possible due to requirements to send other Layer 3 messages, the measurements shall be discarded and new measurements scheduled at the next possible opportunity. If extended measurements can not be reported within 10 seconds after the triggering EMO was received, they shall be discarded (and not reported).

If the EMO message contains frequencies outside the MS' frequency band, the MS shall set the corresponding RXLEV value(s) to zero.

After a successful channel change, no Extended Measurement Report shall be sent if the EMO was received before that channel change.

After having performed Extended Measurements during one reporting period, the mobile station shall resume the measurements according to the current BA list. This applies for each rescheduling of the Extended measurements.

8.5 Absolute MS-BTS distance

8.5.1 General

The Absolute MS-BTS distance may be employed by the network as a criterion in the handover processes.

8.5.2 Physical parameter

The information being used by the BSS to perform "adaptive frame alignment" (GSM 05.10) in the MS is a representation of the absolute distance of the MS to the serving BTS.

This absolute distance may be used by the BSS to prevent MS from grossly exceeding the planned cell boundaries.

The allowable distance is administered on a cell by cell basis by the network operator.

9 Control parameters

The parameters employed to control the radio links are shown in tables 1 and 2.

Table 1: Radio sub-system link control parameters

Parameter name	Description	Range	Bits	Channel
BSIC	Base station Identification Code	0-63	6	SCH D/L
BA	BCCH Allocation	-	-	BCCH D/L
BA_IND	Sequence number of BA	0/1	1	BCCH D/L
MS_TXPWR_MAX_CCH	The maximum TX power level an MS may use when accessing the system until otherwise commanded.	0/31	5	BCCH D/L
POWER OFFSET	The power offset will be used in conjunction with the MS TXPWR MAX CCH parameter by the class 3 DCS 1 800 MS: 0 = 0 dB 1 = 2 dB 2 = 4 dB 3 = 6 dB	0-3	2	BCCH D/L
RXLEV_ACCESS_MIN	Minimum received signal level at the MS required for access to the system.	0-63	6	BCCH D/L
RADIO_LINK_TIMEOUT	The maximum value of the radio link counter 4-64 SACCH blocks, 15 steps of 4 SACCH blocks	-	4	BCCH D/L SACCH D/L
CELL_RESELECT_HYSTERESIS	RXLEV hysteresis for required cell re-selection. 0-14 dB, 2 dB steps, i.e. 0 = 0 dB, 1 = 2 dB, etc.	0-7	3	BCCH D/L
NCC_PERMITTED	Bit map of NCCs for which the MS is permitted to report measurement results. Bit map relates to NCC part of BSIC.	-	8	BCCH D/L
CELL_BAR_ACCESS	See table 1a.	0/1	1	BCCH D/L
CELL_BAR_QUALIFY	See table 1a	0/1	1	BCCH D/L
CELL_RESELECT_PARAM_IND	Indicates the presence of C2 cell reselection parameters (1 = parameters present)	0/1	1	BCCH D/L
CELL_RESELECT_OFFSET	Applies an offset to the C2 reselection criterion. 0 - 126 dB, 2 dB steps, i.e. 0 = 0 dB, 1 = 2 dB, etc.	0-63	6	BCCH D/L
TEMPORARY_OFFSET	Applies a negative offset to C2 for the duration of PENALTY_TIME. 0 - 60 dB, 10 dB steps i.e. 0 = 0 dB,. 1 = 10 dB, etc. and 7 = infinity	0-7	3	BCCH D/L
PENALTY_TIME	Gives the duration for which the temporary offset is applied. 20 to 620 s, 20 s steps, i.e. 0 = 20 s, 1 = 40 s, etc. 31 is reserved to indicate that CELL_RESELECT_OFFSET is subtracted from C2 and TEMPORARY_OFFSET is ignored.	0-31	5	BCCH D/L

Table 1a: Parameters affecting cell priority for cell selection

CELL_BAR QUALIFY	CELL_BAR ACCESS	Cell selection priority	Status for cell reselection
0	0	normal	normal
0	1	barred	barred
1	0	low	normal (see note 2)
1	1	low	normal (see note 2)

If all the following conditions are met, then the "Cell selection priority" and the "Status for cell reselection" shall be set to normal:

- the cell belongs to the MS HPLMN;
- the MS is in cell test operation mode;
- the CELL_BAR_ACCESS is set to "1";
- the CELL_BAR_QUALIFY is set to "0";
- the Access Control class 15 is barred.

NOTE 1: A low priority cell is only selected if there are no suitable cells of normal priority (see GSM 03.22).

NOTE 2: Two identical semantics are used for cross phase compatibility reasons. This allows an operator to declare a cell always as a low priority one for a phase 2 MS, but keeps the opportunity for an operator to decide whether a phase 1 MS is permitted to camp on such a cell or not.

Table 2: Handover and power control parameters - slow ACCH

Parameter name	Description	Range	Bits	Message
MS_TXPWR_REQUEST (ordered MS power level)	The power level to be used by an MS	0-31	5	L1 header downlink
MS_TXPWR_CONF. (actual MS power level)	Indication of the power level in use by the MS.	0-31	5	L1 header uplink
POWER_LEVEL	The power level to be used by an MS on the indicated channel	0-31	5	HO/assignment command
RXLEV_FULL_SERVING_CELL	The RXLEV in the current serving cell accessed over all TDMA frames	0-63	6	Measurement results
RXLEV_SUB_SERVING_CELL	The RXLEV in the current serving cell accessed over a subset of TDMA frames	0-63	6	Measurement results
RXQUAL_FULL_SERVING_CELL	The RXQUAL in the current serving cell, assessed over all TDMA frames.	0-7	3	Measurement results
RXQUAL_SUB_SERVING_CELL	The RXQUAL in the current serving a cell, assessed over subset of TDMA frames.	0-7	3	Measurement results
DTX_USED	Indicates whether or not the MS used DTX during the previous measurement period.	-	1	Measurement results
BA_USED	Value of BA_IND for BCCH allocation used	0/1	1	Measurement results
RXLEV_NCELL_(1-6)	The RXLEV assessed on BCCH carrier as indicated in the BCCH Allocation	0-63	6	Measurement results
BCCH_FREQ_NCELL_(1-6)	The BCCH carrier RF channel number in NCELL.	0-31	5	Measurement results
BSIC_NCELL_(1-6)	Base station identification code for NCELL.	0-63	6	Measurement results
MULTIBAND_REPORTING	Indication of the number of cells to be reported for each band in multiband operation.	0-3	2	BACCH D/L and SACCH D/L

NOTE 1: RXLEV and RXQUAL fields are coded as described in clause 8.
NOTE 2: BCCH_FREQ_NCELL_(1-6) is coded in accordance with GSM 04.08 as the position in the list of BA carriers which is arranged in increasing numerical order according to the absolute RF channel number. The lowest position is coded 0.
NOTE 3: For the details of the Measurement Result message see GSM 04.08.

10 GPRS mode tasks

10.1 Cell Re-selection

In GPRS Standby and Ready states, cell re-selection is performed by the MS, except for a class A MS (see GSM 02.06) while in dedicated mode of a circuit switched connection, in which case the cell is determined by the network according to the handover procedures (see subclause 3). When the circuit switched connection is released, the MS shall resume cell re-selection (see subclause 6.7.1).

The cell re-selection procedures defined in subclauses 10.1.1. to 10.1.3. apply to the MSs attached to GPRS if a PBCCH exists in the serving cell or if the GPRS cell re-selection parameters are provided to the MS in an Packet Measurement Order message (see 04.60). Otherwise the MS shall perform cell re-selection according to the idle mode procedures defined in clause 6.

In addition, the network may control the cell selection as defined in subclause 10.1.4.

The cells to be monitored for cell re-selection are defined in the BA(GPRS) list, which is broadcast on PBCCH. If PBCCH does not exist, BA(GPRS) is equal to BA(BCCH).

10.1.1 Monitoring the received signal level and PBCCH data

The MS shall measure the received RF signal level on the BCCH carriers of the serving cell and the surrounding cells as indicated in the BA(GPRS) list and optionally the NC_FREQUENCY_LIST, and calculate the received level average (RLA_P) for each carrier.

In addition the MS shall verify the BSIC of the BCCH carriers. Only cells with the same BSIC as broadcast together with BA(GPRS) shall be considered for re-selection.

10.1.1.1 Packet idle mode

Whilst in packet idle mode (see 03.64) an MS shall continuously monitor all BCCH carriers as indicated by the BA(GPRS) list and the BCCH carrier of the serving cell. At least one received signal level measurement sample on each BCCH carrier shall be taken for each paging block monitored by the MS according to its current DRX mode and its paging group. As the minimum MS shall take one measurement for each BCCH carrier for every 4 second. As the maximum, the MS is however not required to take more than 20 samples per second.

RLA_P shall be a running average determined using samples collected over a period of 5 s to
Max {5s, five consecutive paging blocks of that MS}, and shall be maintained for each BCCH carrier. The same number of measurement samples shall be taken for all BCCH carriers, and the samples allocated to each carrier shall as far as possible be uniformly distributed over the evaluation period. At least 5 received signal level measurement samples are required for a valid RLA_P value.

The list of the 6 strongest non-serving carriers shall be updated at a rate of at least once per running average period.

The MS shall attempt to decode the full PBCCH data at least every 30 seconds. The MS is not required to decode the BCCH data of the serving cell or any data of the non-serving cells.

The MS shall attempt to check the BSIC for each of the 6 strongest non-serving cell BCCH carriers at least every 14 consecutive paging blocks of that MS or 10 seconds, whichever is greater. If a change of BSIC is detected then the carrier shall be treated as a new carrier.

When requested by the user, the MS shall determine which PLMNs are available as described in subclause 6.6.1. However, for MSs without DRX or with short DRX period (see GSM 05.02), considerable interruptions to the monitoring of PPCH or PCH can not be avoided.

10.1.1.2 Packet transfer mode

Whilst in packet transfer mode an MS shall continuously monitor all BCCH carriers as indicated by the BA(GPRS) list and the BCCH carrier of the serving cell. In every TDMA frame, a received signal level measurement sample shall be taken on at least one of the BCCH carriers, one after the another. Optionally, measurements during up to 2 TDMA frames per PDCH multiframe may be omitted if required for BSIC decoding.

RLA_P shall be a running average determined using samples collected over a period of 5 s, and shall be maintained for each BCCH carrier. The same number of measurement samples shall be taken for all BCCH carriers except, if the parameter PC_MEAS_CHAN indicates that the power control measurements shall be made on BCCH (see subclause 10.2.3.1.2), for the serving cell where at least 6 measurement samples shall be taken per 52-multiframe. The samples allocated to each carrier shall as far as possible be uniformly distributed over the evaluation period. At least 5 received signal level measurement samples are required for a valid RLA_P value.

If an MS with a multislot class number 19-29 (see GSM 05.02), performing a multislot downlink packet transfer with dynamic or extended dynamic allocation (see GSM 04.60), is not able to perform received signal level measurements within the TDMA frame according to its multislot class, the MS shall perform the measurements during the block period where the uplink acknowledge is sent. During this block period, the MS shall use the time slots after the PDCH carrying PACCH for measurements according to its measurement capability (see GSM 05.02).

NOTE 1: The network is responsible for providing the necessary acknowledgement block periods to ensure that the MS will perform the required number of measurements.

If an MS with a multislot class number 19-29 (see GSM 05.02), performing a multislot uplink or downlink transfer with fixed allocation (see GSM 04.60), is not able to perform received signal level measurements within the TDMA frame

according to its multislot class, the MS shall perform the measurements during inactivity periods, defined in the assignment command (see GSM 04.60), according to its measurement capability (see GSM 05.02).

NOTE 2: The network is responsible for providing the necessary inactivity periods to ensure that the MS will perform the required number of measurements.

The MS shall attempt to check the BSIC for each of the 6 strongest non-serving cell BCCH carriers as often as possible, and at least every 10 seconds. The MS shall use the two Idle frames of the PDCH multiframe for this purpose. These frames are termed “search” frames. A list containing BSIC and timing information for these strongest carriers at the accuracy required for accessing a cell (see GSM 05.10) including the absolute times derived from the parameters T1, T2, T3 shall be kept by the MS. This information may be used to schedule the decoding of BSIC and shall be used when re-selecting a new cell in order to keep the switching time at a minimum. When a BCCH carrier is found to be no longer among the 6 strongest, BSIC and timing information shall be retained for 10 seconds. (This is in case a cell re-selection command to this cell is received just after the MS has stopped reporting that cell, see subclause 10.1.4.2).

If an MS, performing a multislot uplink transfer with fixed allocation, is not able to perform BSIC decoding within the search frames according to its multislot class, the MS shall perform the BSIC decoding between allocations. The MS shall determine the necessary periods by not requiring uplink resources.

If an MS, performing a multislot downlink transfer with fixed allocation, is not able to perform BSIC decoding within the search frames according to its multislot class, the MS shall perform the BSIC decoding during inactivity periods. The MS shall request these inactivity periods from the network to allow for the required BSIC decoding (see GSM 04.60).

If, after averaging measurement results over 4 PDCH multiframes (1 sec), the MS detects one or more BCCH carriers, among the 6 strongest, whose BSICs are not currently being assessed, then the MS shall as a matter of priority attempt to decode their BSICs.

The MS shall be able to send the first packet random access (PRACH) at the latest 5 s after a new strongest cell (which is part of the BA(GPRS)) has been activated under the following network conditions: Initial serving cell at RXLEV= -70 dBm, with 6 neighbours at RXLEV= -75 dBm. Then the new PBCCH carrier is switched on at RXLEV= -60 dBm.

Note: Because of test equipment limitations it is acceptable to activate the new carrier to replace one of the 6 neighbours.

In the case of a multiband MS, the MS shall attempt to decode the BSIC, if any BCCH carrier with unknown BSIC is detected among the number of strongest BCCH carriers in each band as indicated by the Multiband Reporting parameter (see subclause 8.4.3).

Thus an MS shall, for a period of up to 5 seconds, devote all search frames to attempting to decode these BSICs. If this fails then the MS shall return to confirming existing BSICs. Having re-confirmed existing BSICs, if there are still BCCH carriers, among the six strongest, with unknown BSICs, then the decoding of these shall again be given priority for a further period of up to 5 seconds.

If either no BSIC can be decoded on a surrounding cell BCCH carrier, or the BSIC is not the same as broadcast for that carrier in the BA(GPRS) list, then the received signal level measurements on that channel shall be discarded and the MS shall continue to monitor that channel.

If a change of BSIC is detected on a carrier, then any existing received signal level measurement shall be discarded and the carrier shall be treated as a new carrier.

If the BSIC cannot be decoded at the next available opportunities re-attempts shall be made to decode this BSIC. If the BSIC is not decoded for more than three successive attempts it will be considered lost and any existing received signal level measurement shall be discarded and the MS shall continue to monitor that carrier.

10.1.2 Cell Re-selection Criteria

The following cell re-selection criteria are used for GPRS, whereby (s) denotes the serving cell, and (n_i) denotes the neighbour cells. . Different parameter values may apply for each neighbour cell. One set of parameters is broadcast in each cell.

1) The path loss criterion parameter C1 is used as a minimum signal level criterion for cell re-selection for GPRS in the same way as for GSM Idle mode. C1 is the same as defined in subclause 6.4, except that

A = RLA_P - GPRS_RXLEV_ACCESS_MIN
B = GPRS_MS_TXPWR_MAX_CCH - P

The GPRS specific parameters GPRS_RXLEV_ACCESS_MIN and GPRS_MS_TXPWR_MAX_CCH for the serving cell and neighbour cells are broadcast on PBCCH of the serving cell (POWER OFFSET is not used).

2) The signal level threshold criterion parameter C31 for hierarchical cell structures (HCS) is used to determine whether prioritised hierarchical cell re-selection shall apply and is defined by:

C31(s) = RLA_P(s) - HCS_THR(s) (serving cell)
C31(n) = RLA_P(n) - HCS_THR(n) - TO(n) * L(n) (neighbour cell)

where HCS_THR is the signal threshold for applying HCS re-selection. HCS_THR is broadcast on PBCCH of the serving cell.

3) The cell ranking criterion parameter (C32) is used to select cells among those with the same priority and is defined by:

C32(s) = C1(s) (serving cell)
C32(n) = C1(n) + GPRS_RESELECT_OFFSET(n) - TO(n) * (1-L(n)) (neighbour cell)
where

GPRS_RESELECT_OFFSET applies an offset and hysteresis value to each cell

TO(n) = GPRS_TEMPORARY_OFFSET(n) * H(GPRS_PENALTY_TIME(n) - T(n)).

L(n) = 0 if PRIORITY_CLASS(n) = PRIORITY_CLASS(s)
1 if PRIORITY_CLASS(n) ≠ PRIORITY_CLASS(s)

H(x) = 0 for x < 0
1 for x ≥ 0

GPRS_TEMPORARY_OFFSET applies a negative offset to C31/C32 for the duration of GPRS_PENALTY_TIME after the timer T has started for that cell. T is defined in subclause 6.4.

GPRS_RESELECT_OFFSET, PRIORITY_CLASS, GPRS_TEMPORARY_OFFSET and GPRS_PENALTY_TIME are broadcast on PBCCH of the serving cell.

10.1.3 Cell Re-selection Algorithm

At least for every new sample or every second, whichever is the greatest, the MS shall update RLA_P and calculate the value of C1, C31 and C32 for the serving cell and the non-serving cells. The MS shall make a cell re-selection if:

i) The path loss criterion parameter (C1) for the serving cell falls below zero.

ii) A non-serving suitable cell (see GSM 03.22) is evaluated to be better than the serving cell. The best cell is the cell with the highest value of C32 among

- those cells that have the highest PRIORITY_CLASS among those that fulfil the criterion C31 ≥ 0, or
- all cells, if no cells fulfil the criterion C31 ≥ 0.

If the parameter C32_QUAL is set, positive GPRS_RESELECT_OFFSET values shall only be applied to the neighbour cell with the highest RLA_P value of those cells for which C32 is compared above.

PRIORITY_CLASS and C32_QUAL are broadcast on PBCCH of the serving cell.

When evaluating the best cell, the following hysteresis values shall be subtracted from the C32 value for the neighbour cells:

- in standby state, if the new cell is in the same routing area: 0.
- in ready state, if the new cell is in the same routing area: GPRS_CELL_RESELECT_HYSTERESIS. If the parameter C31_HYST is set,

GPRS_CELL_RESELECT_HYSTERESIS shall also be subtracted from the C31 value for the neighbour cells.

- in standby or ready state, if the new cell is in a different routing area: RA_RESELECT_HYSTERESIS.

- in case of a cell re-selection occurred within the previous 15 seconds: 5 dB.

  GPRS_CELL_RESELECT_HYSTERESIS, C31_HYST and RA_RESELECT_HYSTERESIS are broadcast on PBCCH of the serving cell.

Cell re-selection for any other reason (see GSM 03.22) shall take place immediately, but the cell that the MS was camped on shall not be returned to within 5 seconds if another suitable cell can be found. If valid RLA_P values are not available, the MS shall wait until these values are available and then perform the cell re-selection if it is still required. The MS may accelerate the measurement procedure within the requirements in subclause 10.1.1 to minimise the cell re-selection delay.

If no suitable cell is found within 10 seconds, the cell selection algorithm of GSM 03.22 shall be performed. Since information concerning a number of channels is already known to the MS, it may assign high priority to measurements on the strongest carriers from which it has not previously made attempts to obtain BCCH information, and omit repeated measurements on the known ones.

10.1.3.1 Abnormal cell reselection

In the event of an abnormal release with cell reselection (see GSM 04.60) when PBCCH exists, an abnormal cell reselection based on BA(GPRS) shall be attempted. The MS shall perform the following algorithm to determine which cell to be used for this cell reselection attempt.

i) The received level measurement samples taken on the carriers indicated in the BA (GPRS) received on the serving cell in the last 5 seconds shall be averaged, and the carrier with the highest received level average (RLA) with permitted BSIC, i.e. the same as broadcast together with BA (GPRS), (see subclause 10.1.1), shall be taken.

ii) On this carrier the MS shall attempt to decode the PBCCH data block containing the parameters affecting cell selection.

iii) If the parameter C1 is greater than zero, it is part of the selected PLMN, the cell is not barred, and access in another cell is allowed, i.e. RANDOM_ACCESS_RETRY bit is set, abnormal cell reselection shall be attempted on this cell.

iv) If the MS is unable to decode the PBCCH data block or if the conditions in iii) are not met, the carrier with the next highest received level average (RLA) with permitted BSIC shall be taken, and the MS shall repeat steps ii) and iii) above.

v) If the cells with the 6 strongest received level average (RLA) values with permitted BSICs have been tried but cannot be used, the abnormal cell reselection attempt shall be abandoned, and the algorithm of subclause 10.1.3 shall be performed.

The MS is under no circumstances allowed to access a cell to attempt abnormal cell reselection later than 20 seconds after the detection within the MS of the abnormal release causing the abnormal cell reselection attempt. In the case where the 20 seconds elapses without a successful abnormal cell reselection the attempt shall be abandoned, and the algorithm of subclause 10.1.3 shall be performed.

In the event of an abnormal release with cell reselection (see GSM 04.60) when only BCCH exists, the MS shall only perform the algorithm of subclause 10.1.3.

10.1.4 Network controlled Cell re-selection

The network may request measurement reports from the MS and control its cell re-selection. This is indicated by the parameter NETWORK_CONTROL_ORDER. The meaning of the different parameter values is specified as follows:

NC0 Normal MS control
The MS shall perform autonomous cell re-selection.

NC1	MS control with measurement reports The MS shall send measurement reports to the network as defined in subclause 10.1.4.1. The MS shall perform autonomous cell re-selection.
NC2	Network control The MS shall send measurement reports to the network as defined in subclause 10.1.4.1. The MS shall not perform autonomous cell re-selection.
RESET	The MS shall return to the broadcast parameters. Only sent on PCCCH or PACCH.

The parameter values NC1 and NC2 only apply in Ready state. In Standby state, the MS shall always use normal MS control independent of the ordered NC mode.

A set of measurement reporting parameters (NETWORK_CONTROL_ORDER and NC_REPORTING_PERIOD(s)) is broadcast on PBCCH. The parameters may also be sent individually to an MS on PCCCH or PACCH, in which case it overrides the broadcast parameters. The individual parameters are valid until the RESET command is sent to the MS or there is a downlink signalling failure.

A parameter NC_FREQUENCY_LIST may also be sent individually to an MS on PCCCH or PACCH. This list adds/deletes frequencies to the BA(GPRS) both for cell re-selection and for measurement reports. For added frequencies, the corresponding cell re-selection parameters are included, The list is valid until an empty list is sent to the MS, there is a downlink signalling failure or the MS selects a new cell.

All signalling for support of network controlled cell re-selection and measurement reports are defined in GSM 04.60.

10.1.4.1 Measurement reporting

When ordered to send measurement reports, the MS shall continuously monitor all carriers in BA(GPRS) or as indicated by the parameter NC_FREQUENCY_LIST and the BCCH carrier of the serving cell. Received signal level measurement samples shall be taken as often as defined in subclause 10.1.1. for the actual packet mode.

For each carrier, the measured received signal level (RXLEV) shall be the average of the received signal level measurement samples in dBm taken on that carrier within the reporting period as indicated by the parameters NC_REPORTING_PERIOD_I for packet idle mode and NC_REPORTING_PERIOD_T for packet transfer mode. In averaging, measurements made during previous reporting periods shall always be discarded. The start of the first reporting period may be random.

After each reporting period, the MS shall send a measurement report to BSS (see GSM 04.60). The measurement report shall contain:

- RXLEV for the serving cell.

- in packet idle mode, the average interference level γ_{ch} (see subclause 10.2.3.2) for the serving cell measured on the monitored PCCCH if a valid value is available.

- received signal level for the non-serving cells. Carriers shall be reported if they are among the 6 strongest carriers and BSIC is successfully decoded and equal to the BSIC of the list.

In the case of Packet Transfer mode with the NC_REPORTING_PERIOD_T = 0.48 s the MS shall report a new strongest cell in the measurement report at the latest 5 s after a new strongest cell (which is part of the BA(GPRS)) has been activated under the following network conditions: Initial serving cell at RXLEV= -70 dBm, with 6 neighbours at RXLEV= -75 dBm. Then the new PBCCH carrier is switched on at RXLEV= -60 dBm.

Note: Because of test equipment limitations it is acceptable to activate the new carrier to replace one of the 6 neighbours.

10.1.4.2 Cell re-selection command

A cell re-selection command may be sent from the network to an MS. When the MS receives the command, it shall immediately re-select the cell according to the included cell description and change the network control mode according to the command (see GSM 04. 60).

10.1.4.3 Exceptional cases

An MS in network control mode NC1 or NC2 may enter any of the following exceptional cases:

- a circuit switched connection is established, which takes precedence over GPRS cell re-selection;

- an anonymous access is performed.

In such a case the MS is not required to send measurement reports according to subclause 10.1.4.1, and shall not obey any cell re-selection command.

In the anonymous access case the MS shall continue to make measurements and, in mode NC1, perform autonomous cell re-selection, using the current frequency list (NC_FREQUENCY_LIST or BA(GPRS)). In mode NC2, the MS shall stay in the current cell until the anonymous access ends. Whenever the exceptional case ends and provided that the MS is still in Ready state, the MS shall resume the latest received network control mode and obey cell re-selection commands. In the anonymous access case, the MS shall continue the ongoing measurements. In the circuit switched case, the MS shall restart a new measurement period.

10.1.5 Extended Measurement reporting

The network may request measurement reports from the MS for other purposes than cell re-selection. This is indicated by the parameter EXT_MEASUREMENT_ORDER. The meaning of the different parameter values is specified as follows:

EM0 The MS shall not perform extended measurements.

EM1 The MS shall send extended measurement reports to the network.

RESET The MS shall return to the broadcast parameters. Only sent on PCCCH or PACCH.

All signalling for support of extended measurement reports are defined in GSM 04.60.

A set of measurement reporting parameters (EXT_MEASUREMENT_ORDER, EXT_FREQUENCY_LIST and EXT_REPORTING_PERIOD is broadcast on PBCCH. The parameters may also be sent individually to an MS on PCCCH or PACCH, in which case it overrides the broadcast parameters. The individual parameters are valid until the RESET command is sent to the MS, there is a downlink signalling failure or the MS selects a new cell.

When ordered to send extended measurement reports, the MS shall monitor all carriers as indicated by the parameter EXT_FREQUENCY_LIST, which also indicates one of three different types of reporting:

Type 1: Carriers that shall be reported if they are among the 6 strongest carriers regardless of whether BSIC was decoded or not. The measurement report shall contain received signal level and, if successfully decoded, BSIC.

Type 2: Carriers that shall be reported if they are among the 6 strongest carriers and BSIC is successfully decoded and with allowed NCC part. The measurement shall contain received signal level and BSIC.

Type 3: Carriers that shall be reported without BSIC decoding. The measurement report shall contain received signal level. In addition interference may be reported for one carrier.

Received signal level measurement samples shall be taken as often as defined in subclause 10.1.1.1. These measurements shall not reduce the rate of measurements for cell re-selection. However, in total the MS is not required to make more than 200 samples per second. For each carrier, the measured received signal level (RXLEV) shall be the average of the received signal level measurement samples in dBm taken on that carrier within the reporting period as indicated by the parameter EXT_REPORTING_PERIOD. In averaging, measurements made during previous reporting periods shall always be discarded. The start of the first reporting period may be random.

If indicated in the EXT_FREQUENCY_LIST, interference measurements shall be performed on one carrier. The measurements shall be made in the search frames and PTCCH frames of the 52-multiframe as described in subclause 10.2.3.2.1. During at least two contiguous such frames (one of each type) per paging period, the MS shall make measurements on as many channels (timeslots) as possible on the indicated carrier, considering its DRX mode and multislot class. Averaging shall be done within the reporting period.

The measurement samples shall be taken during the first 480 ms of the reporting period or until 5 samples have been taken on each carrier, whichever is longer. If the MS is in packet transfer mode or in an exceptional case (see subclause 10.1.4.3.) when the measurements shall start, the MS shall wait until it returns to packet idle mode. If the MS enters packet transfer mode or an exceptional case during the measurement period, the measurements shall be discarded and the measurements restarted when the MS returns to packet idle mode. If the MS is not able to collect the required measurements during one reporting period due to its DRX period, it may continue the measurements during the next reporting period. In this case no report shall be sent in the first reporting period.

For type 1 and 2 reporting, the MS shall attempt to decode the BSIC for the 6 strongest carriers in each reporting period, as close to the measurements as possible. Priority shall however be given to decoding BSIC for cell re-selection to fulfil the requirements in subclause 10.1.1.2.

After collecting the measurements for one reporting period, the MS shall send a measurement report to BSS (see GSM 04.60). The measurement report shall be sent independently of the packet mode but not in the exceptional cases defined in subclause 10.1.4.3.

10.2 RF Power Control

NOTE: Power control is not applicable to point-to-multipoint services.

10.2.1 MS output power

The RF output power, P_{CH} , to be employed by the MS on each individual uplink PDCH shall be:

$$P_{CH} = \min(\Gamma_0 - \Gamma_{CH} - \alpha * (C + 48), PMAX), \quad (1)$$

where

Γ_{CH} is an MS and channel specific power control parameter, sent to the MS in an RLC control message (see GSM 04.60).

Γ_0 = 39 dBm for GSM900
= 36 dBm for DCS1800

α is a system parameter, broadcast on PBCCH or optionally sent to MS in an RLC control message (see GSM 04.08 and 04.60).

C is the normalised received signal level at the MS as defined in 10.2.3.1.

PMAX is the maximum allowed output power in the cell = GPRS_MS_TXPWR_MAX_CCH if PBCCH exists MS_TXPWR_MAX_CCH otherwise

All power values are expressed in dBm.

When the MS receives new Γ_{CH} or α values, the MS shall use the new value to update P_{CH} according to equation (1) 2 radio blocks after the end of the last timeslot of the message block containing the new value.

The MS may round the calculated output power to the nearest nominal output power value (see GSM 05.05) although a higher resolution is preferred. The output power actually transmitted by the MS shall fulfil the absolute accuracy as specified in 05.05. In addition, the transmitted power shall be a monotonic function of the calculated output power and any change of 2 dB in the calculated value shall correspond to a change of 2 ± 1.5 dB in the transmitted value.

The MS shall use the same output power on all four bursts within one radio block.

When accessing a cell on the PRACH or RACH (random access) and before receiving the first power control parameters during packet transfer on PDCH, the MS shall use the output power defined by PMAX.

MS_TXPWR_MAX_CCH is broadcast on the BCCH of the cell. A class 3 DCS1800 MS shall add to it the value POWER OFFSET broadcast on the BCCH .

GPRS_MS_TXPWR_MAX_CCH is broadcast on PBCCH of the serving cell.

If a calculated output power is not supported by the MS, the MS shall use the supported output power which is closest to the calculated output power.

10.2.2 BTS output power

On the PBCCH, PCCCH and the PTCCH/D the BTS shall use constant output power, which may be lower than the output power used on BCCH. The power reduction (Pb) used on PCCCH, relative to the output power used on BCCH, is broadcast on PBCCH.

On other PDCH radio blocks, downlink power control may be used. The BTS shall use the same output power on all four bursts within one radio block except for bursts transmitted on the BCCH carrier. Thus, a procedure may be implemented in the network to control the power of the downlink transmission based on the Channel Quality Reports. On each PDTCH/D block, the PR field of the MAC header shall indicate the power level used for the next downlink radio block on the same time slot. Any radio block following a PACCH/D block, shall be transmitted with unchanged power level, since the PR field only exists in the MAC header of the RLC data block (see GSM 04.60).

As an exception to the above, the network shall send the first block of each multiframe (B0) in each of the PDCHs with the same power as PBCCH, or BCCH if PBCCH does not exist.

NOTE: The output power must be sufficient for the MS for which the RLC block is intended as well as the MS(s) for which the USF is intended (see GSM 04.60).

10.2.3 Measurements at MS side

A procedure shall be implemented in the MS to monitor periodically the downlink Rx signal level and quality from its serving cell.

10.2.3.1 Deriving the C value

10.2.3.1.1 Packet idle mode

In packet idle mode, the MS shall periodically measure the received signal level of the PCCCH or, if PCCCH is not existing, the BCCH. The MS shall measure the received signal level of each paging block monitored by the MS according to its current DRX mode and its paging group.

The normalised C value for each radio block is calculated:

$$C_{block\ n} = SS_{block\ n} + Pb \qquad (2)$$

where

$SS_{block\ n}$ is the mean of the received signal level of the four normal bursts that compose the block.

Pb is the BTS output power reduction (relative to the output power used on BCCH) used on the channel on which the measurements are performed. For PCCCH, Pb is broadcast on PBCCH. If frequency hopping is being used on the associated physical channel, Pb shall be reduced by 25% for each burst in the block which is received on the BCCH frequency. For BCCH, Pb =0 (not broadcast).

Finally, the $C_{block\ n}$ values are filtered with a running average filter:

$$C_n = (1-a) * C_{n-1} + a * C_{block\ n},\ C_0=0, \quad (3)$$

where a is the forgetting factor:

$a = 1/MIN(n, MAX(5, T_{AVG_W}/T_{DRX})$.

T_{DRX} = DRX period for the MS (see GSM 05.02) =
64/SPLIT_PG_CYCLE if DRX period split is supported
BS_PA_MFRMS otherwise.

If DRX is not used, SPLIT_PG_CYCLE shall be replaced by 768 for PCCCH or 256 for CCCH in this formula.

T_{AVG_W} is broadcast on PBCCH or, if PBCCH does not exist, on BCCH. BS_PA_MFRMS is broadcast on BCCH. SPLIT_PG_CYCLE is defined at GPRS attach.

n is the iteration index. The filter shall be restarted with n=1 for the first sample every time a new cell is selected. Otherwise, when entering packet idle mode, the filter shall continue from the n and C_n values obtained during packet transfer mode. The filter shall also continue from its previous state if T_{DRX} is changed.

The current C_n value shall be used in formula (1) to calculate the output power when the MS transfers its first radio block.

For each block, the MS shall calculate the variance of the received signal level as:

$$BL_VAR_n = 1/3*SUM(SS_k + Pb_k - C_{block\ n})^2,\ k = 1,...,4 \quad (4)$$

where

SS_k = the received signal level of burst k within the block.

Pb_k = Pb except for bursts received on the BCCH frequency for which $Pb_k = 0$

The reported value, SIGN_VAR, shall be a running average of BL_VAR:

$$SIGN_VAR_n = (1-a) * SIGN_VAR_{n-1} + a * BL_VAR_n \quad (5)$$

where a is the same forgetting factor as in formula (3).

The filter shall be restarted with $SIGN_VAR_0=0$ for the first sample every time a new cell is selected. Otherwise, when entering packet idle mode, the filter shall be restarted with the $SIGN_VAR_0$ value obtained during packet transfer mode.

SIGN_VAR shall be included in the channel quality report (see subclause 10.2.3.2.2).

10.2.3.1.2 Packet transfer mode

In packet transfer mode, the MS shall use the same received signal level measurements on the BCCH carrier of the serving cell as made for cell reselection (see 10.1.1.2). The measurements shall be filtered with a running average filter:

$$C_n = (1-b) * C_{n-1} + b * SS_n, \quad (6)$$

where SS_n is the received signal level of the measurement samples.

b is the forgetting factor:

$b = 1/(6*T_{AVG_T})$.

n is the iteration index. When entering packet transfer mode, the filter shall continue from the n and C_n values obtained during packet idle mode.

If indicated by the parameter PC_MEAS_CHAN, the MS shall instead measure the received signal level of each radio block on one of the PDCH monitored by the MS for PACCH. For each downlink radio block $C_{block\ n}$ shall be derived according to formula (2) (if PBCCH does not exist, Pb = 0). Finally, the $C_{block\ n}$ values are filtered with a running average filter:

$$C_n = (1-c) * C_{n-1} + c * C_{block\ n}, \quad (7)$$

where c is the forgetting factor:

$c = 1/(12*T_{AVG_T})$.

n is the iteration index. When entering packet transfer mode, the filter shall continue from the n and C_n values obtained during packet idle mode.

NOTE 1: This method is suitable in the case where BCCH is in another frequency band than the used PDCHs. It requires that constant output power is used on all downlink PDCH blocks.

The current C_n value shall be used to update formula (1) each time a new C_n value is obtained or whenever the MS applies new Γ_{CH} or α values.

For each correctly received downlink block on one of the PDCH monitored by the MS for PACCH, the MS shall calculate the variance of the received signal level as:

$$BL_VAR_n = 1/(j-1)*SUM(SS_k - SS_{block\ n})^2, k = 1,...,4 \quad (8)$$

where SS_k is the received signal level of burst k within the block.

$SS_{block\ n}$ is the mean of the received signal level of the j normal bursts that compose the radio block.

j is the number of bursts in the radio block = 4.

If frequency hopping is used and 1 burst of the block is received on the BCCH carrier, that burst shall be discarded from the calculation (j = 3). If 2 bursts are received on the BCCH carrier, the whole block shall be discarded. If 3 bursts are received on the BCCH carrier, the other burst shall be discarded (j = 3).

If more than one PDCH are monitored the MS shall for each block period try to find one correctly received block for the BL_VAR calculation. The block may be taken from any of the monitored PDCHs.

The reported value, SIGN_VAR, shall be the average of BL_VAR within the reporting period. The first reporting period starts at the beginning of the downlink transfer. The reporting period ends, and the subsequent reporting period starts, two blocks before the transmission of a quality report. In averaging, measurements made during previous reporting periods shall always be discarded.

SIGN_VAR shall be included in the channel quality report (see subclause 10.2.3.2.1).

An MS, performing an uplink transfer using fixed allocation, is not required to make received signal level measurements and shall thus update P_{CH} during its uplink allocation, only when it receives new Γ_{CH} values. The MS shall in this case use the last C_n value measured before the uplink transfer.

T_{AVG_T} and PC_MEAS_CHAN are broadcast on PBCCH or, if PBCCH does not exist, on BCCH.

10.2.3.2 Derivation of Channel Quality Report

The channel quality is measured as the interference signal level during idle frames of the multiframe, when the serving cell is not transmitting. No measurements shall be taken on the BCCH carrier of the serving cell since the BTS transmits with constant output power on this carrier.

10.2.3.2.1 Packet transfer mode

In packet transfer mode, the MS shall measure the interference signal level on the same carrier as the assigned PDCHs. The MS shall make these measurements during the search frames and PTCCH frames, which are not required for BSIC decoding or the timing advance procedure.

The MS shall perform interference signal measurements on as many of the channels (timeslots) as possible and as a minimum, on those channels that correspond to receiver timeslots according to its multislot capability for the actual allocation.

For each channel, every measurement $SS_{CH,n}$ shall consist of the minimum of the two signal level samples from one search frame and one PTCCH frame. Thus the SACCH frames are avoided (except for a physical channel with two TCH/Hs) and only the interference is measured. The measured interference shall be averaged in a running average filter:

$$\gamma_{CH,n} = (1-d) * \gamma_{CH,n-1} + d * SS_{CH,n}, \gamma_{CH,0} = 0 \quad (9)$$

where d is the forgetting factor:

$d = 1/MIN(n, N_{AVG_I})$.

n is the iteration index.

The filter shall be restarted with n=1 for the first sample every time a new cell is selected. If the measurements on a channel is interrupted due to a change of packet mode (transfer or idle), the last obtained n and $\gamma_{CH,n}$ values shall be saved. When entering packet transfer mode, the filter shall continue from the values obtained during packet idle mode for those channels that are measured in both modes. If frequency hopping is used, channels that only differ in MAIO shall be considered the same. For the other channels, if the measurements are resumed for the same channel within $N_{AVG_I}/2$ multiframes, the filter shall continue from the saved values. Otherwise the filter shall be restarted. Channel reassignment during packet transfer mode shall be considered as start of a new packet transfer mode preceded by a zero length packet idle mode.

For each channel, the MS shall perform at least N_{AVG_I} (rounded to the nearest integer) measurements of $SS_{CH,n}$ before valid γ_{CH} values can be determined.

During downlink transfer, the MS shall measure the received signal quality as defined in subclause 8.2. The reported value, RXQUAL, shall be the average within the reporting period. Only successfully decoded blocks intended for that MS shall be included in the average. The first reporting period starts at the beginning of the downlink transfer. The reporting period ends, and the subsequent reporting starts, two blocks before the transmission of a quality report. In averaging, measurements made during previous reporting periods shall always be discarded.

The MS shall transfer the 8 γ_{CH} values and the RXQUAL, C and SIGN_VAR values (see subclause 10.2.3.1.2) to the network in the Channel Quality Report sent on PACCH.

N_{AVG_I} is broadcast on PBCCH or, if PBCCH does not exist, on BCCH.

10.2.3.2.2 Packet idle mode

In packet idle mode, the MS shall measure the interference signal level on the channels indicated by the parameter INT_MEAS_CHANNEL_LIST and, for an MS performing measurements according to subclause 10.1.4.1., on the monitored PCCCH. INT_MEAS_CHANNEL_LIST is optionally broadcast on PBCCH or, if PBCCH does not exist, on BCCH. The MS shall perform measurements on those channels that are possible according to its multislot capability as described in 10.2.3.2.1. If INT_MEAS_CHANNEL_LIST does not exist and the MS is not performing measurements according to subclause 10.1.4., the MS is not required to perform any interference measurements.

These measurements shall be made in the search frames and the PTCCH frames when the MS is configured on PCCCH and averaged in the same way as described in subclause 10.2.3.2.1. During each paging period, if such frames are available and not required for BSIC decoding or (P)CCCH monitoring, the MS shall make one measurement ($SS_{CH,n}$) on each indicated channel (timeslot) on at least one of the carriers to be measured. The measurements for each channel shall be made on contiguous search and PTCCH frames (one of each type) and shall, as far as possible, be uniformly distributed over the measurement period.

The filter shall be restarted with n=1 for the first sample every time a new cell is selected. If the measurements on a channel is interrupted due to a change of packet mode (transfer or idle), the last obtained n and $\gamma_{CH,n}$ values shall be

saved. When entering packet idle mode, the filter shall continue from the values obtained during packet transfer mode for those channels that are measured in both modes. If frequency hopping is used, channels that only differ in MAIO shall be considered the same. For the other channels, if the measurements are resumed for the same channel within $KC*N_{AVG_I}/4$ multiframes or $KC*N_{AVG_I}/2$ paging periods, whichever is greater, the filter shall continue from the saved values. Otherwise the filter shall be restarted. KC is the number of carriers in the INT_MEAS_CHANNEL_LIST.

For each channel, the MS shall perform at least N_{AVG_I} (rounded to the nearest integer) measurements of $SS_{CH,n}$ before valid γ_{CH} values can be determined.

N_{AVG_I} is broadcast on PBCCH or, if PBCCH does not exist, on BCCH.

10.2.4 Measurements at BSS side

A procedure shall be implemented in the BSS to monitor the uplink Rx signal level and quality on each uplink PDCH, active as well as inactive.

The BSS shall also measure the Rx signal level and the quality of a specific MS packet transfer.

10.3 Measurement requirements

The accuracy of the received signal level and interference measurements shall be as defined in subclause 8.1.2. The measured signal strength values shall be mapped to the reported C values as defined for RXLEV in subclause 8.1.4. The measured interference level, γ_{CH}, shall be mapped to a reported I_LEVEL value between 0 and 15, relative to C values as follows:

I_LEVEL 0 = interference level is greater than C
I_LEVEL 1 = interference level is less than or equal to C and greater than C - 2 dB
I_LEVEL 2 = interference level is less than or equal to C - 2 dB and greater than C - 4 dB
:
:
I_LEVEL 14 = interference level is less than or equal to C - 28 dB and greater than C - 30 dB
I_LEVEL 15 = interference level is less than or equal to C - 30 dB

4 bits are required to express each I_LEVEL value.

10.4 Control parameters

The parameters employed to control the radio links for GPRS are shown in table 3.

Table 3: Radio sub-system link control parameters for GPRS

((s) and (n) denote serving cell and non-serving cell respectively)

Parameter name	Description	Range	Bits	Channel
BA(GPRS)	BCCH Allocation for GPRS re-selection Note: If PBCCH does not exist, BA(GPRS) = BA(BCCH)	-	-	PBCCH D/L
BSIC(s+n)	Base station Identification Code for carriers in BA(GPRS) and the serving BCCH carrier	0-63	6	PBCCH D/L
BA_GIND	Sequence number of BA(GPRS)	0/1	1	PBCCH D/L
MS_TXPWR_MAX_CCH	See table 1.	0-31	5	BCCH D/L
POWER OFFSET(s)	See table 1.	0-3	2	BCCH D/L
RXLEV_ACCESS_MIN	See table 1.	0-63	6	BCCH D/L
GPRS_MS_TXPWR_MAX_CCH(s+n)	The maximum TX power level an MS may use when accessing the system	0-31	5	PBCCH D/L
GPRS_RXLEV_ACCESS_MIN(s+n)	Minimum received signal level at the MS required for access to the system.	0-63	6	PBCCH D/L
GPRS_RESELECT_OFFSET (n)	Applies an offset and hysteresis to the C32 re-selection criterion. -52, -48,..., -12, -10,..., 12, 16, ...,48 dB	0-31	5	PBCCH D/L
PRIORITY_CLASS (s+n)	The HCS priority for the cells	0-7	3	PBCCH D/L
HCS_THR(s+n)	HCS signal level threshold -110, -108,..., -48 dBm	0-31	5	PBCCH D/L
GPRS_TEMPORARY_OFFSET(n)	Applies a negative offset to C32 for the duration of PENALTY_TIME. 0, 10,..., 60 dB, infinity	0-7	3	PBCCH D/L
GPRS_PENALTY_TIME(n)	Gives the duration for which the temporary offset is applied. 10, 20,..., 320 seconds	0-31	5	PBCCH D/L
GPRS_CELL_RESELECT_ HYSTERESIS	Additional hysteresis applied in Ready state for cells in the same RA. 0, 2,..., 14 dB	0-7	3	PBCCH D/L
RA_RESELECT_HYSTERESIS	Additional hysteresis applied for cells in different RAs. 0, 2,..., 14 dB	0-7	3	PBCCH D/L
CELL_RESELECT_HYSTERESIS	Additional hysteresis applied for cells in different RAs if PCCCH does not exist. See table 1.	0-7	3	BCCH D/L
C32_QUAL	Flag indicating an exception rule for GPRS_RESELECT_OFFSET	1/0	1	BBCCH D/L
C31_HYST	Flag indicating if hysteresis shall be applied to C31.	1/0	1	PBCCH D/L
α	Power control parameter 0,0.1,...,1	0-10	4	PBCCH D/L (**)
Pb	Power reduction used by BTS on PBCCH blocks, relatively to the output power used on BCCH 0, -2,..., -30 dB	0-15	4	PBCCH D/L
PC_MEAS_CHAN	Flag that indicates whether the downlink measurements for power control shall be made on BCCH or PDCH.	0/1	1	PBCCH D/L (**)
T_{AVG_W}	Signal level filter period for power control in packet idle mode $2^{(k/2)}$/ 6 multiframes, k = 0,1,..., 25	0-25	5	PBCCH D/L (**)
T_{AVG_T}	Signal level filter period for power control in packet transfer mode $2^{(k/2)}$/ 6 multiframes, k = 0,1,..., 25	0-25	5	PBCCH D/L (**)
N_{AVG_I}	Interference signal level filter constant for power control $2^{(k/2)}$, k = 0,1,..., 15	0-15	4	PBCCH D/L (**)

(continued)

Table 3 (concluded): Radio sub-system link control parameters for GPRS

Parameter name	Description	Range	Bits	Channel
INT_MEAS_CHANNEL_LIST	Channel list for interference measurements in packet idle mode	-	-	PBCCH D/L (**)
NETWORK_CONTROL_ORDER	Controls cell re-selection and measurement reporting	0-3	2	PBCCH D/L PCCCH D/L PACCH D/L
NC_FREQUENCY_LIST	Frequency list for cell re-selection measurement reporting	-	-	PCCCH D/L PACCH D/L
NC_REPORTING_PERIOD_I NC_REPORTING_PERIOD_T	Time period for measurement reporting 0.48, 0.96, 1.92, ..., 61.44 seconds	0-7	3	PBCCH D/L PCCCH D/L PACCH D/L
EXT_MEASUREMENT_ORDER	Controls extended measurement reporting	0-3	2	PBCCH D/L PCCCH D/L PACCH D/L
EXT_FREQUENCY_LIST	Frequency list for extended measurement reporting	-	-	PBCCH D/L PCCCH D/L PACCH D/L
EXT_REPORTING_PERIOD	Time period for measurement reporting 60, 120, 240,..., 7680 seconds	0-7	3	PBCCH D/L PCCCH D/L PACCH D/L

(**) These parameters occur also on BCCH if PBCCH does not exist.

Annex A (informative): Definition of a basic GSM or DCS 1 800 handover and RF power control algorithm

A.1 Scope

This annex specifies a basic overall handover algorithm and RF power control process that may be implemented in the GSM or DCS 1 800 system.

The specification includes a set of algorithms that are sufficient to allow the successful implementation of an initial GSM or DCS 1 800 system, and from which more complex algorithms may be developed.

The basic solution is not mandatory for network operators.

A.2 Functional requirement

The present algorithm is based on the following assumptions:

- Single cell BSS.
- The necessity to make a handover according to radio criteria is recognized in the BSS. It can lead to either an (internal) intracell handover or an intercell handover.
- Evaluation of a preferred list of target cells is performed in the BSS.
- Cell allocation is done in the MSC.
- Intracell handover for radio criteria (interference problems) may be performed directly by the BSS.
- The necessity to make a handover because of traffic reason (network directed handover) is recognized by the MSC and it is performed by sending a "handover candidate enquiry message" to BSS.
- The RF power control algorithm shall be implemented in order to optimize the RF power output from the MS (and BSS if power control is implemented) ensuring at the same time that the signal level received at the BSS (MS) is sufficient to keep adequate speech/data quality.
- All parameters controlling the handover and power control processes shall be administered on a cell by cell basis by means of O&M. The overall handover and power control process is split into the following stages:

  i) BSS pre-processing and threshold comparisons.

  ii) BSS decision algorithm.

  iii) MSC cell allocation algorithm.

A BSS decision algorithm is specified such that the BSS can fulfil the mandatory requirement of being able to produce a preferred list of target cells for handover.

It should be noted that since measurement results can also be sent to the MSC in the "handover required" message, the handover decision algorithm may be implemented in either the MSC or the BSS.

A.3 BSS pre-processing and threshold comparisons

For the purpose of handover and RF power control processing, the BSS shall store the parameters and thresholds shown in table A.1. These shall be administered on a cell by cell basis and downloaded to the BSS by O&M procedures.

The parameters and thresholds related to the downlink power control process are stored and used only if BSS RF power control is implemented.

The following measurements shall be continuously processed in the BSS:

i) Measurements reported by MS on SACCH:

- Down link RXLEV;
- Down link RXQUAL;
- Down link surrounding cell RXLEV (RXLEV_NCELL (n) on BCCH as indicated in the BCCH Allocation).

ii) Measurements performed in BTS:

- Uplink RXLEV;
- Uplink RXQUAL;
- MS-BTS distance;
- Interference level in unallocated time slots.

Every SACCH multiframe (480 ms) a new processed value for each of the measurements shall be calculated.

A.3.1 Measurement averaging process

The BSS shall be capable of pre-processing the measurements by any of the following processes:

- Unweighted average;
- Weighted average, with the weightings determined by O&M;
- Modified median calculation, with exceptionally high and low values (outliers) removed before the median calculation.

The timing of the processing shall be controlled by parameters, set by O&M, as follows:

a) RXLEV_XX (XX = DL or UL):

For every connection and for both links at least the last 32 samples shall be stored (a sample is the value evaluated by the MS and BSS during a period of 480 ms). Every 480 ms, with these samples, the BSS shall evaluate the averaged value of the received power as defined by the parameters Hreqave and Hreqt, applicable to RXLEV.

b) RXLEV_DL on BCCH carriers (RXLEV_NCELL (n)):

For every connection and for each of up to 16 defined cells the BSS shall store the values related to the last 32 samples. The BSS shall average these samples as defined by the parameters Hreqave, Hreqt, applicable to RXLEV.

c) RXQUAL_XX (XX = DL or UL):

For every connection and for both links at least 32 samples shall be stored (a sample is the value calculated by the MS and BSS during period of 480 ms). Every 480 ms, with these samples, the BSS shall evaluate the received signal quality as defined by the parameters Hreqave and Hreqt, applicable to RXQUAL.

d) MS-BTS distance:

For every connection the BSS shall average the adaptive frame alignment value as defined by the parameters Hreqave and Hreqt, to derive an estimate of the MS-BTS distance.

e) Interference level in unallocated time slots:

The BSS shall average the interference level in unallocated timeslots as defined by the Intave parameter. The averaged results shall be mapped into five interference categories (see GSM 08.08) whose limit O-X5 are adjusted by O&M.

f) Power Budget:

This assessment process may be employed by the network as a criterion in the handover process, by setting a flag in the BSS by O&M command. If the process is employed, every 480 ms, for every connection and for each of allowable 32 adjacent cells, the BSS shall evaluate the following expression:

PBGT(n) = (Min(MS_TXPWR_MAX,P) - RXLEV_DL - PWR_C_D) - (Min(MS_TXPWR_MAX(n),P) - RXLEV_NCELL(n))

Where the values of RXLEV_NCELL(n) and RXLEV_DL are obtained with the averaging processes defined above. PWR_C_D is the difference between the maximum downlink RF power permitted in the cell and the actual downlink power due to the BSS power control. MS_TXPWR_MAX is the maximum RF TX power an MS is permitted to use on a traffic channel in the serving cell. MS_TXPWR_MAX (n) is the maximum RF TX power an MS is permitted to use on a traffic channel in adjacent cell n. P is the maximum TX power capability of the MS.

g) Hreqave and Hreqt:

The values of Hreqt and Hreqave are defined by O&M for each cell for the averaging of reported measurements. The values of Hreqave and Hreqt can be different for each of the parameters being averaged.

Hreqave:

defines the period over which an average is produced, in terms of the number of SACCH blocks containing measurement results, i.e. the number of measurements contributing to each averaged measurement.

Hreqt:

is the number of averaged results that are maintained.

The BSS shall support values of Hreqave and Hreqt such that

$0 < Hreqav < 32$

and $0 < Hreqt < 32$

where $Hreqave * Hreqt < 32$

A.3.2 Threshold comparison process

A.3.2.1 RF power control process

Every SACCH multiframe, the BSS shall compare each of the processed measurements with the relevant thresholds. The threshold comparison processes and the actions to be taken are as follows:

a) Comparison of RXLEV_XX with L_RXLEV_XX_P (XX = DL or UL)

The algorithm shall be applied to the averaged RXLEV values (defined in subclause A.3.1:a). The comparison process shall be defined by the parameters P1 and N1 as follows:

- Increase XX_TXPWR if at least P1 averages out of N1 averages are lower than L_RXLEV_XX_P. (e.g. P1 = 10 and N1 = 12)

b) Comparison of RXLEV_XX with U_RXLEV_XX_P (XX = DL or UL)

The algorithm shall be applied to the averaged RXLEV values (defined in subclause A.3.1:a). The comparison process shall be defined by the parameters P2 and N2 as follows:

- Decrease XX_TXPWR if at least P2 averages out of N2 averages are greater than U_RXLEV_XX_P. (e.g. P2 = 19 and N2 = 20)

c) Comparison of RXQUAL_XX with L_RXQUAL_XX_P (XX = DL or UL)

The algorithm shall be applied to the averaged RXQUAL values (defined in subclause A.3.1:c) The comparison process shall be defined by the parameters P3 and N3 as follows:

- Increase XX_TXPWR if at least P3 averaged values out of N3 averaged values are greater (worse quality) than L_RXQUAL_XX_P. (e.g. P3 = 5 and N3 = 7)

d) Comparison of RXQUAL_XX with U_RXQUAL_XX_P (XX = DL or UL) The algorithm shall be applied to the averaged RXQUAL values (defined in subclause A.3.1:c) The comparison process shall be defined by the parameters P4 and N4 as follows:

- Decrease XX_TXPWR if at least P4 averaged values out of N4 averaged values are lower (better quality) than U_RXQUAL_XX_P. (e.g. P4 = 15, N4 = 18)

A.3.2.2 Handover Process

Every SACCH multiframe, the BSS shall compare each of the processed measurements with the relevant thresholds. The threshold comparison processes and the actions to be taken are as follows:

a) Comparison of RXLEV_XX with L_RXLEV_XX_H (XX = DL or UL)

The algorithm shall be applied to the averaged RXLEV values (defined in subclause A.3.1:a). The comparison process shall be defined by the parameters P5 and N5 as follows:

- If at least P5 averaged values out of N5 averaged values are lower than L_RXLEV_XX_H a handover, cause XX_RXLEV, might be required. (e.g. P5 = 10 and N5 = 12).

b) Comparison of RXQUAL_XX with L_RXQUAL_XX_H (XX = DL or UL)

The algorithm shall be applied to the averaged RXQUAL values (defined in subclause A.3.1:c) The comparison process shall be defined by the parameters P6 and N6 as follows:

- If at least P6 averaged values out of N6 averaged values are greater (worse quality) than L_RXQUAL_XX_H a handover, cause XX_RXQUAL, might be required. (e.g. P6 = 5 and N6 = 7).

c) Comparison of RXLEV_XX with RXLEV_XX_IH (XX= DL or UL)

The algorithm shall be applied to the averaged RXLEV values (defined in subclause A.3.1:a). The comparison process shall be defined by the parameters P7 and N7 as follows:

- If at least P7 averaged values out of N7 averaged values are greater than RXLEV_XX_IH an internal handover might be required if RXQUAL_XX is also greater (worse quality) than L_RXQUAL_XX_H (e.g. P7 = 10 and N7 = 12).

d) Comparison of MS-BTS distance with the MAX_MS_RANGE

This comparison process may be employed by the network as a criterion in the handover process by setting a flag in the BSS by O&M. If the process is employed, the algorithm shall be applied to the averaged values defined in subclause A.3.1:d. The comparison process shall be defined by the parameters P8 and N8 as follows:

- If at least P8 averaged values out of N8 values are greater than MS_RANGE_MAX a handover, cause DISTANCE, might be required. (e.g. P8 = 8 and N8 = 10).

e) Comparison of PBGT(n) with the HO_MARGIN(n)

If the process is employed, the action to be taken is as follows:

- If PBGT(n) > O and PBGT(n) > HO_MARGIN(n) a handover, cause PBGT(n), might be required.

This comparison enables handover to be performed to ensure that the MS is always linked to the cell with the minimum path loss, even though the quality and signal level thresholds may not have been exceeded.

A.4 BSS decision algorithm

Recognizing the necessity to request a handover the BSS shall send a "handover required message" to the MSC containing the preferred list of target cells.

The "handover required message" shall be also generated in answer to a "handover candidate enquiry message" sent by the MSC.

The BSS decision algorithm shall be based on the following strategy:

RXLEV_NCELL(n) > RXLEV_MIN(n) + Max (O, Pa) (1)

where: Pa = (MS_TXPWR_MAX(n)-P)

(Min(MS_TXPWR_MAX,P) - RXLEV_DL - PWR_C_D) -(Min(MS_TXPWR_MAX(n),P) -

RXLEV_NCELL(n)) - HO_MARGIN(n) > 0 (2)

All these expressions shall be evaluated using the averaged values defined by the parameters Hreqt and Hreqave.

The BSS shall evaluate the equation (2) for each of the adjacent cells that satisfies the expression (1) and shall compile the list of the preferred adjacent cells ordinated depending on the value of equation (2) (i.e. in the first position is the cell for which the value is the maximum, in the second position is the cell with the second best value and so on).

If there are any adjacent cells for which the values of RXLEV_MIN(n), HO_MARGIN(n) and MS_TXPWR_MAX(n) are not known, i.e. the MS has reported values from an undefined adjacent cell, then the default parameters shall be used to evaluate equations 1 and 2, i.e. RXLEV_MIN_DEF, HO_MARGIN_DEF, MS_TXPWR_MAX_DEF. This enables handover to occur in situations where a call is set up in unexpected coverage area of a cell, without defined adjacent cells.

If there are several cells that satisfy the equation (2) with the same results, the first cell in the list will be that one with the best "positive trend". The trend shall be evaluated by the BSS using the last Hreqt averaged values of RXLEV_NCELL(n).

If the handover is considered imperative, that is one of the following events is verified as the cause:

a) The power level (UL and/or DL) is below the thresholds despite power control (the MS or/and the BSS have reached the maximum allowed power).

b) The quality of the link (UL and/or DL) is below the threshold while at the same time the RXLEV approximates the threshold.

c) The distance between MS and BTS exceeds the MAX_MS_RANGE.

The list of the preferred cells shall be compiled including any candidates for which the result of the equation (2) is lower than 0. Also in this case the list shall be compiled in a decreasing order of priority.

A.4.1 Internal intracell handover according to radio criteria: (Interference problems)

The two conditions RXQUAL_XX > L_RXQUAL_XX_H (bad quality) and RXLEV_XX > RXLEV_XX_IH, if verified at the same time, indicate a high probability of the presence of co-channel interference.

This situation can be solved by changing the channel within the cell with an intracell handover.

If internal intracell handover is supported by the BSS it shall be performed as described in GSM 08.08.

If the BSS does not support internal intracell handover, then the handover shall be initiated by sending a "handover required message" to the MSC in which the serving cell is indicated as first priority.

A.4.2 Internal handover according to other criteria

Apart from radio criteria there are other criteria that may require internal handover:

- O&M criteria;
- Resource management criteria.

In these cases, internal handover shall be triggered by the OMC or by the resource management of the BSS.

A.4.3 General considerations

Since the RF power control process and the handover process are closely linked, particular care shall be taken in order to avoid undesired interactions between them.

In particular, the following interactions should be avoided, where possible:

- A "power increase command" or a "handover for RXLEV or for RXQUAL" subsequent to a "power reduction command" (e.g. by checking that the averaged power level reduced by the Pow_Red_Step_Size plus the tolerances is greater than the L_RXLEV_XX_P or L_RXLEV_XX_H).
- A "power reduction command" subsequent to a "power increase command".

After an action of power control the set of samples related to the previous power level, in the corresponding link, shall not be used in the processing.

If, during the decision process, the condition for the "handover required message" is satisfied at the same time by different reasons. The "cause field" in the "handover required message" sent to the MSC, shall contain the reasons taking account of the following order of priority:

- RXQUAL;
- RXLEV;
- DISTANCE;
- PBGT.

A.5 Channel allocation

As described in GSM 08.08 the available channels shall be divided into five interference categories whose limits O-X5 are adjusted by O&M command.

For handover, the channel allocated should be from the category with the lowest interference level, since determination of the expected value of C/I is not possible by the new BSS.

A.6 Handover decision algorithm in the MSC

The MSC shall select the cell to which an MS is to be handed over by the following criteria:

- Handover for radio criteria shall be handled taking into account the following order of priority:
  - RXQUAL;
  - RXLEV;
  - DISTANCE;
  - PBGT.

e.g. if there are more handover bids to a cell than there are free traffic channels, then the bids with cause "RXQUAL" shall take highest priority.

- In order to avoid overload in the network, for every cell and with reference to each of 16 adjacent cells, it shall be possible to define (by O&M) for each adjacent cell one of at least 8 priority levels. These shall be considered together with the list of candidates and the interference levels in the choice of the new cell. For example, if there are two cells which meet the criteria for handover, then the cell with the highest priority shall be used. This enables umbrella cells, for instance, to be given a lower priority, and only handle calls when no other cell is available.

- Channel congestion on the best cell shall cause the choice of the second best cell, if available, and so on. If no cell is found and call queuing is employed in the MSC, then the MSC shall queue the request on the best cell for a period equal to H_INTERVAL (H_INTERVAL < T_Hand_RQD shall be set by O&M). This handover shall have priority over the queue handling new calls.

Table A.1: Parameters and thresholds stored for handover purposes

L_RXLEV_UL_P	RXLEV threshold on the uplink for power increase. Typical range - 103 to - 73 dBm.
U_RXLEV_UL_P	RXLEV threshold on the uplink for power reduction.
L_RXQUAL_UL_P	RXQUAL threshold on the uplink for power increase.
U_RXQUAL_UL_P	RXQUAL threshold on the uplink for power reduction.
L_RXLEV_DL_P	RXLEV threshold on the downlink for power increase. Typical range - 103 to - 73 dBm.
U_RXLEV_DL_P	RXLEV threshold on the downlink for power reduction.
L_RXQUAL_DL_P	RXQUAL threshold on the downlink for power increase.
U_RXQUAL_DL_P	RXQUAL threshold on the downlink for power reduction.
L_RXLEV_UL_H	RXLEV threshold on the uplink for handover process to commence. Typical range - 103 to - 73 dBm.
L_RXQUAL_UL_H	RXQUAL threshold on the uplink for handover process to commence.
L_RXLEV_DL_H	RXLEV threshold on the downlink for handover process to commence. Typical range - 103 to - 73 dBm.
L_RXQUAL_DL_H	RXQUAL threshold on the downlink for handover process to commence.
MS_RANGE_MAX	Threshold for the maximum permitted distance between MS and current BTS. Range (2, 35 Km); step size 1.0 Km.
RXLEV_UL_IH	RXLEV threshold on uplink for intracell (interference) handover. Typical range - 85 to - 40 dBm.
RXLEV_DL_IH	RXLEV threshold on downlink for intracell (interference) handover; typical range - 85 to - 40 dBm.
RXLEV_MIN(n)	Minimum RXLEV required for an MS to be allowed to handover to cell "n".
RXLEV_MIN_DEF	Default value of RXLEV_MIN, used to evaluate handover to undefined adjacent cells.
HO_MARGIN(n)	A parameter used in order to prevent repetitive handover between adjacent cells. It may be also used as a threshold in the power budget process. Range (0, 24 dB); step size 1 dB.
HO_MARGIN_DEF	Default value of HO_MARGIN, used to evaluate handover to undefined adjacent cells.
N_CELL list	List of allowable adjacent cells for handover. Range (0, 32).
MS_TXPWR_MAX	Maximum TX power a MS may use in the serving cell. Range (5, 39 dBm) for GSM and (0,36 dBm) for DCS 1 800; step size 2 dB.
MS_TXPWR_MAX(n)	Maximum TX power a MS may use in the adjacent cell "n". Range (5, 39 dBm) for GSM and (0,36 dBm) for DCS 1 800; step size 2 dB.
MS_TXPWR_MAX_DEF	Default value of MS_TXPWR_MAX, used to evaluate handover to undefined adjacent cells.
BS_TXPWR_MAX	Maximum TX power used by the BTS.
O .X5	Boundary limits of five interference bands for the unallocated time slots. Typical range -115 to -85 dBm. (See GSM 08.08).
Hreqave	RXLEV, RXQUAL and MS_BTS Distance averaging periods defined in terms of number of SACCH multiframes. Range (1, 31); step size 1.
Hreqt	The number of averaged results that can be sent in a "handover required message" from BSS to MSC. Range (1, 31); step size 1.
Intave	Interference averaging period defined in terms of the number of SACCH multiframes. Range (1, 31); step size 1.
N1..N8,P1..P8	The number of samples used in the threshold comparison processes. Range (1, 31); step size 1.
P_Con_INTERVAL	Minimum interval between changes in the RF power level. Range (0, 30 s) step size 0.96 s.
T_Hand_RQD	Minimum interval between handover required messages related to the same connection. Range (0, 30 s); step size 0.96 s.
Pow_Incr_Step_Size	Range 2, 4 or 6 dB.
Pow_Red_Step_Size	Range 2 or 4 dB.
Number of Ranges (NR)	Number of ranges in BA_RANGE indicating the number of ranges of ARFCNs containing BCCH carriers for use as stored BCCH information.
RANGEi_LOWER	Lowest ARFCN in the ith range of carriers containing BCCH carriers for use as stored BCCH information.
RANGEi_HIGHER	Highest ARFCN in the ith range of carriers containing BCCH carriers for use as stored BCCH information.

All thresholds shall be able to take any value within the range of the parameter to which they apply. Typical operating ranges are given for some thresholds.

Annex B (informative): Power Control Procedures

Power control is important for spectrum efficiency as well as for power consumption in a cellular system. For good spectrum efficiency quality based power control is required. Power control for a packet oriented connection is more complicated than for a circuit switched connection, since there is no continuos two-way connection.

The power control formula for the MS is specified in subclause 10.2.1 (formula 1):

$$P = \Gamma_0 - \Gamma_{CH} - \alpha (C + 48) \quad \text{(all power calculations in dB)}$$

This is a flexible tool that can be used for different power control algorithms. (Note that the constants Γ_0 and 48 are included only for optimising the coding of Γ_{CH}).For the BTS, there is no need to specify any algorithm, but a similar formula can be used. The following are examples of possible algorithms for uplink power control:

- Open loop control.
  With this method the output power is based on the received signal level assuming the same path loss in uplink and downlink. This is useful in the beginning of a packet transmission.

- Closed loop control.
  With this method the output power is commanded by the network based on received signal level measurements made in the BTS in a similar way as for a circuit switched connection.

- Quality based control.
  This method can be used in combination with any of the two methods above.

B.1 Open loop control

A pure open loop is achieved by setting $\alpha = 1$ and keeping Γ_{CH} constant. The output power will than be:

$$P = \Gamma_0 - \Gamma_{CH} - C - 48$$

The value Γ_{CH} can be calculated as follows to give a target value for the received signal, SS_b, at the BTS.

The received signal level at the MS:

$$SS_m = P_{BTS} - P_b - L$$

where P_{BTS} = BTS maximum output power
P_b = BTS power reduction due to power control
L = path loss

The C value (normalised received signal level):

$$C = SS_m + P_b = P_{BTS} - L$$

The MS output power: $P = \Gamma_0 - \Gamma_{CH} - C - 48 = \Gamma_0 - \Gamma_{CH} - P_{BTS} + L - 48$

The received signal level at the BTS:

$$SS_b = P - L = \Gamma_0 - \Gamma_{CH} - P_{BTS} - 48$$

The constant value of Γ_{CH}:

$$\Gamma_{CH} = \Gamma_0 - P_{BTS} - SS_b - 48$$

B.2 Closed loop control

A pure closed loop is achieved by setting $\alpha = 0$. The output power will than be:

$$P = \Gamma_0 - \Gamma_{CH}$$

In this case, Γ_{CH} is the actual power level (relative to Γ_0) commanded by network. It can be based on the received signal level measured at the BTS. Power control commands can be sent when required in order to achieve the target received signal level.

B.3 Quality based control

In order to achieve the best performance the power control should be quality based. The algorithm must also consider the path loss for stability. The algorithm is not specified, it is the responsibility of the manufacturer and/or the operator.

An example of a quality based power control algorithm is:

$$P_{n+1} = P_{max} - \alpha ((C/I_n - C/I_{min}) - (P_n - P_{max})) = P_{ref} - \alpha (C/I_n - P_n)$$

where P is the output power from the MS.
C/I is the received carrier to interference value at the BTS.
P_{max} ,C/I_{min} and P_{ref} are reference values.
α is a weighting factor.
n is the iteration index.

In the closed loop case, this formula determines Γ_{CH}:

$$\Gamma_{CH} = \Gamma_0 - P_{n+1} .$$

For the open loop case, we rewrite the formula. The carrier to interference can be written:

$$C/I = C_{BTS} - I_{BTS} = P - L - I_{BTS}$$

where C_{BTS} is the received signal level at the BTS.
I_{BTS} is the received interference level at the BTS.

thus $P_{n+1} = P_{ref} - \alpha (P_n - L_n - I_{BTS,n} - P_n) = P_{ref} + \alpha (L_n + I_{BTS,n})$

As shown above, the path loss is:

$$L = P_{BTS} - C$$

The formula can therefore be written as (dropping the iteration index):

$$P = P_{ref} + \alpha (P_{BTS} - C + I_{BTS}) = \Gamma_0 - \Gamma_{CH} - \alpha (C - 48)$$

Thus, for the open loop case:

$$\Gamma_{CH} = \Gamma_0 - P_{ref} - \alpha (P_{BTS} + I_{BTS} - 48)$$

The interference level I_{BTS} is measured in the BTS. The parameter Γ_{CH} is estimated based on these measurements, considering the appropriate weighting factor α, and the known parameters P_{ref} and P_{BTS}. The Γ_{CH} values are transferred to the MS in the Power Control Parameters (see GSM 04.60).

B.4 BTS power control

The same algorithm as above can be used for downlink power control. The formula for quality based control in the MS

$$P_{n+1} = P_{ref} + \alpha (L_n + I_{BTS,n})$$

can be written for the BTS as:

$$Pd_{n+1} = P_{ref} + \alpha (L_n + \gamma_{CH,n})$$

where Pd is the BTS output power (equal to $P_{BTS} - P_b$).
γ_{CH} is the received interference level at the MS.

Substituting the path loss and dropping the iteration index gives:

$$P_d = P_{ref} + \alpha (P_{BTS} - C + \gamma_{CH})$$

The received signal C and interference γ_{CH} is measured in the MS and transferred to the BTS, which can calculate the output power.

B.5 Example

Figure B.1 illustrates an example of the uplink power control function.

In packet idle mode, the MS measures the C value on each monitored PPCH block. Meanwhile, the BSS measures the interference of the candidate PDCHs in order to have Γ_{CH} values ready for the first transfer period. This is transferred to the MS in the Packet Uplink Assignment.

In packet transfer mode, the MS measures the C value on the BCCH carrier and updates its output power. The BSS updates the MS specific Γ_{CH} values and transfer them to the MS when needed, i.e. when the interference level has changed.

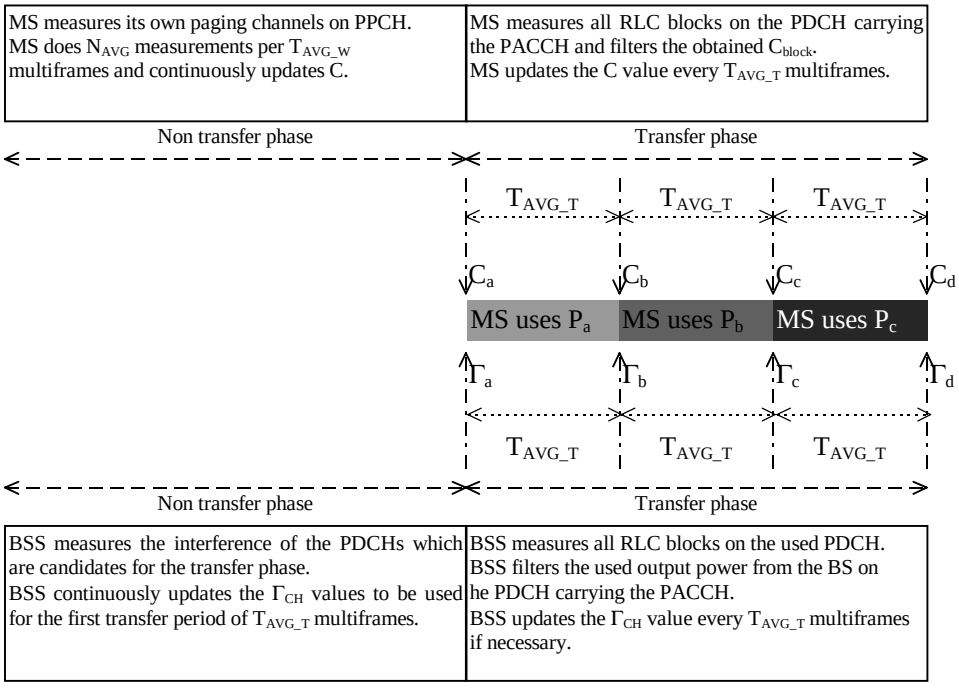


Figure B.1: Traffic example of uplink power control

Figure B.2 illustrates an example of the downlink power control function.

In packet idle mode, the MS measures the C value on each monitored PPCH block. and the γ_{CH} values on some candidate PDCHs.

In packet transfer mode, the MS measures the C value on the BCCH carrier and the γ_{CH} values on all channels on the same carrier as the assigned PDCH. These values are transferred to the BTS in the Packet Downlink Ack/Nack messages. The BSS then updates the output power.

The BTS may use the maximum power for the first transfer period and set the polling for Ack/Nack as soon as possible to get the values measured in packet idle mode.

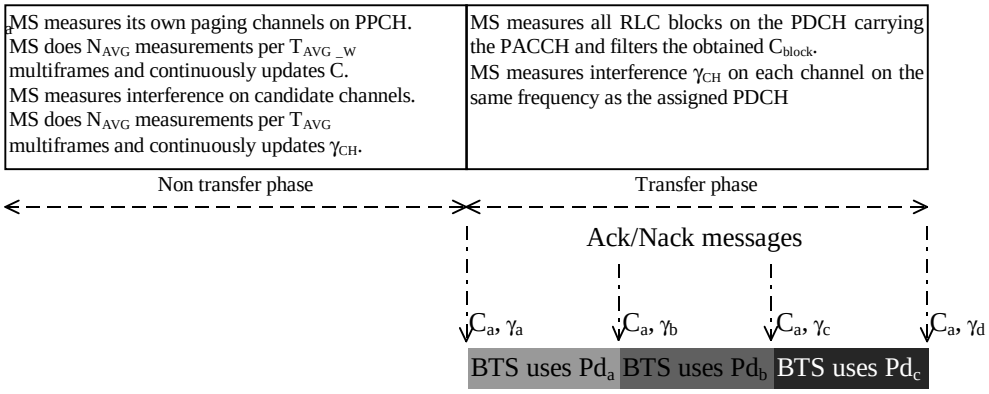


Figure B.2: Traffic example of downlink power control

Annex C (informative): Change Request History

SPEC	SMG#	CR	PHS	VERS	NEW_V	SUBJECT
05.08	s24	A043	R97	5.5.0	6.0.0	Channel Quality Report in GPRS
05.08	s25	A046	R97	6.0.0	6.1.0	Improvements to GPRS power control
05.08	s25	A047	R97	6.0.0	6.1.0	Cell re-selection in GPRS
05.08	s25	A050	R97	6.0.0	6.1.0	Cell re-selection in GPRS
05.08	s25	A051	R97	6.0.0	6.1.0	GPRS Cell Re-selection
05.08	s25	A053	R97	6.0.0	6.1.0	Interference measurements for GPRS
05.08	s25	A054	R97	6.0.0	6.1.0	Renaming of GPRS RR states
05.08	s25	A055	R97	6.0.0	6.1.0	Transmission on downlink PDCH
05.08	s25	A056	R97	6.0.0	6.1.0	RF power level control during configuration change procedure
05.08				6.1.0	6.1.1	Correction of version number
05.08	s26	A057	R97	6.1.0	6.2.0	Corrections and clarifications to GPRS
05.08	s26	A058	R97	6.1.0	6.2.0	Cell re-selection in GPRS
05.08	s26	A059	R97	6.1.0	6.2.0	Mapping of PACCH
05.08	s26	A060	R97	6.1.0	6.2.0	Coding of parameter GCH
05.08	s26	A061	R97	6.1.0	6.2.0	RXQUAL measurement
05.08	s26	A063	R97	6.1.0	6.2.0	Clarification of non-DRX mode
05.08	s26	A064	R97	6.1.0	6.2.0	Release of dedicated channels
05.08	s26	A065	R97	6.1.0	6.2.0	Renaming of broadcast parameters
05.08	s26	A066	R97	6.1.0	6.2.0	Measurement reporting and network controlled cell selection
05.08	s27	A044	R97	6.2.0	6.3.0	MS delay time in reporting a new strongest neighbouring cell
05.08	s27	A068	R97	6.2.0	6.3.0	Clarification of Power Control
05.08	s27	A069	R97	6.2.0	6.3.0	Measurement reporting
05.08	s27	A072	R97	6.2.0	6.3.0	GPRS idle mode measurements
05.08	s27	A074	R97	6.2.0	6.3.0	Clarification of Complete BA (SACCH)
05.08	s27	A075	R97	6.2.0	6.3.0	Tolerances for power control
05.08	s27	A076	R97	6.2.0	6.3.0	GPRS downlink power control
05.08	s28	A080	R97	6.3.0	6.4.0	MS delay time in reporting a new strongest neighbouring cell in GPRS
05.08	s28	A081	R97	6.3.0	6.4.0	Cell re-selection
05.08	s28	A082	R97	6.3.0	6.4.0	Interference measurements on Network command
05.08	s28	A086	R97	6.3.0	6.4.0	Clarification of received signal level
05.08	s28	A087	R97	6.3.0	6.4.0	Interference measurements with frequency hopping

05.08	s28	A088	R97	6.3.0	6.4.0	Clarification of interference measurements
05.08	s28	A089	R97	6.3.0	6.4.0	Call reestablishment procedure for abnormal release with cell reselection in ready state
05.08	s28	A093	R97	6.3.0	6.4.0	Application time of Gamma and Alpha parameters for the computation on MS output power
05.08	s28	A094	R97	6.3.0	6.4.0	Clarification on MAFA measurement requirements
05.08	s28	A096	R97	6.3.0	6.4.0	Cell reselection delay time in packet transfer mode
05.08	s28	A097	R97	6.3.0	6.4.0	Clarification to a requirement to perform the interference measurements
05.08	s28	A098	R97	6.3.0	6.4.0	Neighbour measurements
05.08	s28	A099	R97	6.3.0	6.4.0	End of measurement period for the quality measurements
05.08	s28	A102	R97	6.3.0	6.4.0	Correction to I_LEVEL reporting

History

Document history				
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